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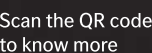
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Top court quashes FIRs against Gen Z protesters

SC invokes Article 142 to close all criminal cases over the July protests, allows Delhi Police to file fresh FIR against protesters with 'criminal antecedents'; CJP withdraws call for September 5 march

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court, at the urging of the Centre, took a rare and extraordinary step on Tuesday to quash criminal cases registered against Gen Z protesters involved in nationwide stir linked to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) following the NEET-UG, 2026 question paper leaks.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant exercised its absolute powers under Article 142 of the Constitution to do "complete justice" and ensure that the first information reports (FIRs) over the protests "will not be investigated, and will be closed for all intents and purposes".

The court clarified its or-



CJP co-conveners Saurav Das and other members celebrate in front of the Supreme Court after the order on Tuesday. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

der was not confined to Delhi, but extended to all States and Union Territories where protests took place.

This came after a volte-face from the Delhi Police, which comes under the jurisdiction of the Union Home Ministry. Faced with the spectre of a CJP march

on September 5, just days ahead of a high-profile BRICS summit in the National Capital, the Delhi Police told the court on August 31 that it did not wish to pursue the FIRs. Following Tuesday's decision, the CJP announced it was withdrawing its call for the march.

CJP co-conveners Saurav Das, who was present in the court room and was invited to address the Bench, noted the "positive assurances" of the government and the "judicial sanctity bestowed upon them" and said that the CJP looked forward to compliance with the "historic" order.

The Bench, however, allowed the Delhi Police to file a "fresh and specific" FIR against 2,873 individuals with criminal antecedents, who were spotted by facial recognition technology at the Jantar Mantar protest site in central Delhi. The court said the FIRs should not prejudice their rights, and they should be given every opportunity to defend themselves.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**

IN BRIEF

Commercial LPG cylinder rate hiked by ₹10

NEW DELHI

Reversing course after two months of decline, the price of the commercial variant of LPG was hiked by ₹10 a cylinder across the country on Tuesday. The price of domestic cylinders remained unchanged. » **Page 14**

Ram Temple to get its first CEO today

NEW DELHI

The search panel constituted to select the first CEO of the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has shortlisted three candidates. The trust is expected to choose one of the three candidates on Wednesday. » **Page 14**

OPPORTUNITIES » **PAGE 5**

SCO must dismantle terror ecosystem: PM

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) "must dismantle" the entire ecosystem of terrorism and send a strong message to countries that practise terrorism as a state policy, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Tuesday in his remarks at the 26th summit of the bloc in Bishkek, the capital of the Kyrgyz Republic.

The Prime Minister's sharp remarks came even as Pakistan took over the baton of SCO chair for 2026-27. India blames Pakistan for cross-border terrorism.

Mr. Modi also called for "peace and stability" in Afghanistan and highlighted the humanitarian assistance that New Delhi has



PM Narendra Modi addressing the SCO summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyz Republic, on Tuesday. ANI

been providing Kabul over the years. The Bishkek Declaration, issued after the conclusion of the summit, also called for an "inclusive government" in Taliban-ruled Afghanistan and expressed "deep concern" over the ongoing war in the Persian Gulf region.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**
KEY PRIORITY
» **PAGE 16****'India should be vocal about international law violations'****Stanly Johny**

India needs to be more vocal about violations of international law and use its global weight to push for peace between Israel and Palestine, Varsen Aghabekian Shahin, the Palestinian Foreign Minister, has said while urging India to examine arms transfers to Israel seriously.

In an interview with *The Hindu*, Ms. Shahin said Palestine had a "very long-standing relationship" with India and had no issue with the country maintaining friendly ties with Israel. On the two-state solution, she said there was "no other solution".

FULL INTERVIEW ON
» **PAGE 16****DEVASTATED VALLEY**
Nepal flood toll crosses 1,000 amid fresh alerts**WORLD** » **PAGE 16****RISE IN FIGURES**
GST revenue grows to nearly ₹2 lakh crore**BUSINESS** » **PAGE 15**

NCLT Special Bench stays Chandra relief

Aaratika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

In a setback to Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra, a five-member Special Bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Tuesday stayed an August 25 ruling by a single-member Bench of the tribunal that cleared a repayment plan requiring him to pay ₹6.25 crore towards admitted claims of ₹22,006.57 crore in personal insolvency proceedings against him. It also restrained Mr. Chandra from alienating his assets.

The Bench found that earlier opinions in the case had failed to yield a clear



Subhash Chandra

majority. It issued notices to the parties and sought their replies ahead of the next hearing on September 23. The Bench assured the parties that they would be heard at length before a final decision was taken on the repayment plan.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12****Policy ek baar,
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Har Pal Aapke Saath

AAP criticises EC over 1.67 lakh deletions in Burari, seeks details

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A day after the draft electoral rolls for Delhi were published under the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) drive, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Tuesday hit out at the Election Commission (EC) for the removal of around 1.67 lakh names from the Burari Assembly constituency – highest in terms of absolute number of deletions among Delhi’s 70 seats.

The Opposition party alleged that despite repeated requests, the EC has refused to share the details of the removed names.

According to official data, Burari is followed by Okhla (1,63,829), Badarpur (1,46,673) and Vikaspuri (1,46,225) in absolute numbers of exclusions. However, Tughlaqabad has the highest percentage of deletions at 47.8.

AAP’s Burari MLA Sanjeev Jha said nearly 40% of names have been ‘shifted’

Nearly 40% names have been marked ‘shifted’ and deleted, said Burari MLA Sanjeev Jha

and later removed.

“Previously, there were 4,26,451 voters; now, only 2,52,189 remain.” He alleged that the names of a large number of migrant workers and tenants have been removed. Mr. Jha said his party had informed the poll panel that Booth Level Officers did not reach several areas and less than 50% of the enumeration work had been completed.

AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj said the party has repeatedly asked the EC to share the names, phone numbers and addresses of those whose names were removed so that the party can verify the details.

When reached for comment, the commission did not respond.

66% names dropped from draft roll marked ‘shifted’

31.59 lakh exclusions marked ‘permanently shifted’; of these, over 10 lakh electors are aged 30-39, show data: 1,042 booths account for 4.5 lakh ‘shifted’ entries, mainly in South East, South districts

Suruchi Kumari
Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI



Chief Electoral Officer of Delhi Ashok Kumar at a press briefing on Monday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

More than six in every 10 names left out of Delhi’s draft roll published on Monday are marked ‘permanently shifted’ and account for the largest share of the 47.56 lakh exclusions in the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) drive.

Of the entries removed at the draft stage, 31.59 lakh are marked ‘permanently shifted’, 11.73 lakh ‘untraceable/absent’, 2.82 lakh ‘dead’ and 1.41 lakh ‘duplicate’ or ‘already enrolled’. Over 10 lakh of those marked ‘permanently shifted’ are aged 30-39.

The excluded entries have been placed in four categories – ‘absent’, ‘shifted’, ‘dead’ and ‘duplicate’ (ASDD). Analysis of the list of ASDD voters

across all 14,947 polling booths, uploaded on the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) website, shows that in at least one booth in each of the 70 Assembly constituencies, over 95% of the names were placed in one of the four categories.

In 1,042 of the 1,090 booths where at least 95% of the removals were attributed to a single reason, ‘permanently shifted’ was the reason. These 1,042

booths together account for nearly 4.5 lakh deletions, of which 4.37 lakh were classified as ‘permanently shifted’. Most of these booths – where at least 95% of the excluded names are marked ‘permanently shifted’ – are in South East (216) and South (204) districts, with North East at the third spot (147).

Most such booths are in Deoli, Tughlaqabad, Okhla, Karawal Nagar, Kasturba Nagar and Mustafabad.

Single-reason pattern

Nearly half of the 1,090 booths with such a highly concentrated single-reason pattern were located near another booth with the same pattern.

In two polling booths in Shyam Nagar under the Rajouri Garden constituency, all 617 removed names were marked as ‘absent/untraceable’.

SIR: HC bins petition on exclusion of homeless

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court has dismissed a public interest litigation plea alleging that homeless persons in Delhi risk being left out of the final electoral roll set to be published on November 4, following the special intensive revision (SIR) drive.

A Bench of Chief Justice D.K. Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia dismissed the plea on August 19, stating there is no “vacuum” in the existing mechanism, which provides for enrolment of those without a fixed address.

‘Trackers, SOS buttons must on buses’: govt. to launch inspection drive

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Curtains were illegally installed on the bus in which the minor was raped. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The Delhi government on Tuesday directed all bus operators in the city to strictly comply with prescribed passenger safety, security and operational norms, which include installing location tracking devices, panic or SOS buttons and fire extinguishers on buses.

Terming passenger safety as “non-negotiable”, Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh added that operators have been directed to ensure that buses are parked during night or idle hours only at authorised, secure and adequately lit locations. He added that the Transport Department will undertake enforcement action to check compliance with these directions under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988.

The directions come a day after two men were arrested for the gang rape of a minor on a bus.

The notice stated the directions apply to all buses, including those from other States plying in the city.

“In accordance with the directions of the Supreme Court, operators have been informed that buses cannot be fitted with curtains or window films. The operators have also been directed to strictly ensure prescribed transparency requirements for windshields, rear windows and side windows,” said the Minister. As per reports, curtains had been installed on the bus in which the minor was raped.

Govt. to provide free rooftop solar systems to over 2 lakh households

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved an amendment to the Delhi Solar Energy Policy, 2023, allowing free rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW to consumers with an average consumption of up to 400

units a month. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said 2.3 lakh rooftops would be covered under the policy.

Power Minister Ashish Sood said consumers would get systems at zero cost, with subsidies of ₹78,000 each from Centre and Delhi. The government aims to create 500

MW of additional rooftop solar capacity by 2027.

Subsidised onion

At a separate event, the CM said the government will sell onion at ₹35 per kg through fair price shops and mobile vans, with the Centre set to provide 1,000 tonnes of onion to the city.

Delhi, U.P. Police differ over handling of gang rape case

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The police departments of Uttar Pradesh and Delhi on Tuesday responded to the criticism over the alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl in a moving bus over 60 km from Greater Noida to Kashmere Gate. Even as the Delhi police said they promptly registered a case and launched a probe

while setting aside “jurisdictional issues”, the U.P. police said they could not do much as the complainant had not approached them, nor had their counterparts in the Capital informed them after registering the FIR.

On Monday, a bus driver and a conductor were arrested for the August 4 incident, which has sparked an uproar among the Op-

position. On Tuesday, the Delhi Congress demanded a fast-track trial in the case while Rashtriya Janata Dal MP Sudhakar Singh wrote to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant seeking *suo motu* cognisance of the incident.

Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke called out the “failure” of Union Home Minister Amit Shah and asked if thousands of police personnel

could be deployed at Jantar Mantar, why couldn’t such deployment be used for women’s safety.

Weren’t contacted

Greater Noida DCP Ravi Shankar Nim told *The Hindu*: “The Delhi police did not contact us at all. They are the ones who registered the case, arrested the accused and sent them to jail. Neither did the com-

plainant come to us nor did the Delhi police reach out to us, so we could not do anything.”

DCP (North Delhi) Niharika Bhatt said, “The Kashmere Gate police got the victim examined and filed a case, setting aside jurisdictional issues. Based on CCTV footage and the victim’s testimony, the bus was traced, and the accused were nabbed.”

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CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

SIR 2026

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फॉर्म-6

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फॉर्म-7

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फॉर्म-8

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PM to visit SRCC, speak about Gen Z aspirations

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will address students at Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) on September 5.

This will be the Prime Minister’s second visit to a higher education institution since the 36-day protest at Jantar Mantar.

Mr. Modi was the chief guest at IIT Delhi convocation ceremony on August 8.

During his visit, the Prime Minister will hold an interactive sessions with the Gen Z. The interaction is expected to focus on young Indians, their aspirations and issues shaping the next generation.

In April this year, Mr. Modi marked 100 years of SRCC by releasing a commemorative stamp in New Delhi.

Protest at Jamia: student outfits unite against suspension orders, ‘irregularities’ in admissions

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Almost a week after Jamia Millia Islamia suspended four students and barred them from entering the campus for protesting against alleged irregularities in the spot admission process, multiple student organisations, including the National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) and the All India Students’ Association (AISA), held a protest against the disciplinary action on Tuesday.

On August 26, four students – Ebin Basil, Dhruv Chauhan, Tabrez Afsar and Jasim Ali – received notices temporarily barring them from the campus for periods ranging from three to 10 days for protesting outside the designated protest spot. Students’ groups have been agitating against the alleged irregularities since August 24.

Student groups protesting against the alleged irregularities in spot admission process at JMI on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

They claim that spot admissions have effectively locked out deserving candidates. The administration, however, has maintained that the spot rounds are held to fill vacancies as they arise, and are open to all eligible students.

Joint call

A joint protest call was issued on Tuesday by nine student groups.

Besides the NSUI and AISA, Students’ Federation

of India and Fraternity Movement also participated in the protest.

The NSUI stated in a release that the stir is a continuation of the movement initiated last week through an indefinite sit-in, adding that instead of addressing the legitimate concerns raised by students and affected candidates, the administration “forcibly removed” the protesters and imposed suspension-cum-campus bans.

Pink tickets to continue till Sept. 17; Saheli cards mandatory thereafter, say officials

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Transport Department has announced September 17 as the last day for women commuters to avail of free travel on DTC and cluster buses using the ‘pink tickets’ system. After this, the scheme will not be extended, an official said.

Delhi women will need a Pink Saheli National Common Mobility Card (NCMC) from September 18 onward to travel for free

The new cards were launched on March 2, replacing previous AAP govt.’s ‘pink tickets’ scheme

while non-resident women will have to pay for tickets.

The NCMC cards were launched on March 2 to enable paperless, free travel for women in Delhi, replacing the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government’s ‘pink tickets’ scheme.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has alleged that the AAP-era scheme has been “marred by corruption and that the panic buttons were installed just for show”.

‘Great enthusiasm’

“Women of Delhi have shown tremendous enthusiasm for the Pink Saheli Smart Card. Around 19 lakh women have already applied or registered for the card,” said Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh.

The government has also reduced the number of distribution centres where these cards could be issued from 73 to 38. The number had been increased from 50 at the time of the scheme’s launch to 73.

Upcoming festivals

The deadline falls during the period marked by several festivals, including Janmashtami, Teej and Ganesh Chaturthi, when women travel for religious, cultural and social events.

CM YK

The Dairy, Fisheries and Animal Resources Department of Bihar on Tuesday issued an advisory cautioning against the consumption of "unfamiliar and unusual" fish caught from the flood waters flowing into the State's rivers from Nepal. People living in East and West Champaran districts have reported catching large fish and said some of them fell ill after having consumed them.

INBRIEF



T.N. CM releases water from Mettur dam for irrigation

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday opened the sluice gates of the Stanley Reservoir at Mettur for samba cultivation in the Cauvery delta. The CM reached the Salem airport around 10.15 a.m., and travelled to Mettur by road through Thoppur, Mecheri, and Kunjandiur. He opened the dam at 11.30 a.m. and showered flowers on the gushing water. Mr. Vijay also interacted with farmers and received petitions. The farmers urged him to release water from the dam for more days than the 45 days announced by the government and sought steps to divert surplus water to waterbodies at Thalaivasal.

BJP objects to SP hoarding on Ram Temple ‘donation theft’

U.P. Minister Manoj Pandey on Tuesday accused the Samajwadi Party (SP) of insulting the Brahmin community by displaying a hoarding on the alleged embezzlement of funds at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, outside the party office in Lucknow. The poster allegedly depicts Lord Ram cursing those who have indulged in embezzlement of funds, with some people seeking his forgiveness with folded hands, while others look on. Reacting to the poster, Mr. Pandey said, “The way in which the SP put up a hoarding outside its office today makes me wonder whether they (SP) are repeatedly testing the Brahmins’ patience, or are they challenging it?”. PTI

BJP lawmakers compromised Odisha’s interest by supporting mining law amendments: BJD

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

The Biju Janata Dal (BJD) on Tuesday alleged Odisha’s Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MPs supported the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026 despite being aware that the legislation could deprive the State of nearly ₹1 lakh crore in arrears.

Addressing a press conference here, BJD Rajya Sabha MP Sanrupt Misra said the Odisha government itself had, before the Supreme Court, maintained that the amount constituted a legitimate entitlement of the State. “On behalf of the Odisha government, Advocate General Pitambar Acharya, in an affidavit filed before the Supreme Court, had stated that the ₹1 lakh crore in arrears was Odisha’s leg-



BJD chief Naveen Patnaik

itimate entitlement and that the State would suffer substantial financial loss if it did not receive the amount,” he alleged.

Former Chief Minister and BJD president Naveen Patnaik had earlier strongly objected to the insertion of Section 9D in the Act.

The new provision stipulates that any tax, cess or other levy on mineral rights or mineral-bearing land whether assessed on the basis of mineral quantity, mineral value, royalty payable or otherwise

which had not been deposited with or recovered by the State government before the commencement of the amended Act, would be deemed invalid at all material times.

The provision further states that any such tax, cess or other levy that had already been deposited with or recovered by the State government before the commencement of the amendment would not be liable to be refunded.

‘Rights snatched’

“Through the Amendment Act, the Central government has permanently taken away the rights of State governments over mines and mineral-bearing land,” Mr. Misra alleged.

The BJD has no representation in the Lok Sabha after the BJP won 20 of Odisha’s 21 seats in the 2024 general election.

No metro, costly cab rides: it’s a long, winding road to Jewar airport

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

About 70 km from central Delhi, the Yamuna Expressway leads to an airport that is pulling an entirely new landscape in its wake. In the last few kilometres leading to the Noida International Airport in Jewar, residential towers, warehouses and commercial projects crowd the roadside, signalling a new ecosystem taking shape.

Inside, the contrast is immediate. The terminal is spacious and orderly. But beyond the glass facade, unfinished stretches of land and active construction are constant reminders that the airport is still finding its feet.

Two and a half months after commercial flight services began on June 15, that contrast defines the experience: a smooth airport at the heart of a project that is still catching up.



For residents of Noida and Greater Noida, however, the airport in Jewar has considerably reduced travel time. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

‘Difficult commute’

For residents of Noida and Greater Noida, the airport has reduced travel time. For many in Delhi, however, cab fares and the absence of direct public transport continue to make the journey a trade-off.

Soumit Joshi, a student

from Greater Noida travelling to Lucknow, found the airport geographically closer but not necessarily easier to access.

“This is my first time flying from Noida International Airport. Delhi airport is farther for me, but getting there is much easier and cheaper,” he said.

Rohan Sharma, a technology professional from Moti Bagh in Delhi travell-

ing to Navi Mumbai, found the cost to be the bigger deterrent. His cab fare exceeded ₹1,700 despite travelling outside peak hours.

“The airport experience was smooth, but without cheaper and reliable public transport from Delhi, I would think twice before using it again,” he said.

While public transport options are expanding, the network remains sparse and selective, leaving many passengers dependent on private vehicles and cabs. Passengers travelling from Delhi largely depend on private vehicles, taxis, or app-based cabs.

Depending on the point of origin, a cab to Jewar airport can cost roughly ₹1,200 to ₹3,500.

The airport authorities said Uttar Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation buses connect the air-

port with Noida, Greater Noida, Ghaziabad, Agra, Mathura, Vrindavan, Meerut, Aligarh, Bulandshahr, Farrukhabad, Firozabad, Garhmukteshwar, Hathras, Khurja, Moradabad, and Shikohabad. Haryana Roadways also operates services to and from Fari-dabad and Palwal.

The connectivity challenge is also reshaping where the airport’s workforce chooses to live. Two employees who previously lived in south and central Delhi said they moved to Greater Noida to escape long daily commutes.

The shift, however, came at a high personal cost. “The travel had become exhausting, so I eventually rented a flat in Noida. Earlier, I was living with my family, but now I am paying ₹25,000 for a 1 BHK,” said an employee.

The airport’s master plan envisages a much larger multimodal transport hub, eventually integrating road, metro, and high-speed rail networks.

Closer to home

Meanwhile, residents of Greater Noida are already seeing the advantages of having an airport nearby.

Mukul Rustagi said the airport had substantially reduced travel time. “It takes just about 40 minutes from Greater Noida. There is no rush and the road is excellent,” he said.

Mr. Rustagi believes the airport is changing the economic landscape. His family bought property in Greater Noida in 2018 and he said its value has more than tripled since then.

For now, Jewar airport has taken off. The city around it is catching up.

Suvendu cautions media against ‘compromising on patriotism’, announces aid

Bengal govt. unveils medical cover of up to ₹5 lakh under the CM’s health insurance scheme, ₹5,000 monthly pension for retired journalists; Kolkata Press Club welcomes the initiatives

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Observing that journalists are free to engage in meaningful criticism of his government, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday said they should ensure that patriotism never gets compromised through their work. He was speaking at the launch of social security schemes for journalists, including health insurance and pension for those who have attained 60 years.

“Criticism me and criticise the party. You can also hold constructive discussions and come to meet us if necessary. But when it comes to patriotism, everyone must follow a strict policy. None of us should do anything that weakens the country or creates instability,” he said.

The previous Trinamool Congress government had refused to implement the Ayushman Bharat scheme and rolled out the Swasthya Bima Yojana, you will get treatment in 1,900 hospitals in the State up to ₹5 lakh,” he added.

The CM said all journal-



CM Suvendu Adhikari (right) launching social security schemes for journalists at the State Secretariat in Kolkata on Tuesday. PTI

Swasthya Bima Yojana, those not covered under the Ayushman Bharat Scheme will be entitled to health insurance of up to ₹5 lakh, Mr. Adhikari said.

‘More benefits’

“Under Swasthya Sathi, journalists got treatment in 1,700 hospitals in the State. Under Ayushman Bharat and Mukhyamantri Swasthya Bima Yojana, you will get treatment in 1,900 hospitals in the State up to ₹5 lakh,” he added.

The CM said all journal-

ists would be brought under the scheme and beneficiaries can also avail of treatment in 38,000 hospitals in the country. He said journalists who apply for the benefit will be eligible for Durga Puja bonus. Journalists who have attained 60 years will get monthly pension of ₹5,000, he said.

Kolkata Press Club president Snehashish Sur said it is a “welcome step when the government comes forward and broadens health insurance and pension benefits for journalists”.

Protesters paint Bengali newspaper office saffron

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

A group of saffron-clad men held a protest outside the office of *Anandabazar Patrika* in Kolkata on Tuesday afternoon and painted parts of its white building saffron. After a few hours, authorities of the publication repainted the walls.

The incident comes days after the newspaper published a report on the recent clashes at Jadavpur University with the headline “*Gerua gundami* (Saffron hooliganism)”. An FIR was then registered against the paper’s editorial team.

On August 28, Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had asked the newspaper to “apologise” for the headline within 24 hours and said if it did not, people in saffron would protest.

Assam CM blames NHAI’s poor upkeep for fatal road mishap

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said poor highway maintenance by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) led to a fatal accident near Guwahati on August 30.

Four persons died on the spot after a minibus collided with a truck at Tetelia in Kamrup Metropolitan district. Three others succumbed to their injuries later. “The public claimed that potholes on the national highway caused the accident. The police, in their investigation, found that poor maintenance by the NHAI is responsible for this unfortunate accident,” the Chief Minister said after visiting the site on Monday.

He said the NHAI awarded the road maintenance work to a contractor, who failed to carry it out properly. Mr. Sarma also said Chief Secretary Ravi Kota spoke with the NHAI chairperson after the accident.

“The chairperson assured the State government that repairs would be undertaken immediately and that maintenance work would be monitored more closely in future,” the



CM Himanta Biswa Sarma at the accident site near Guwahati on Monday. PTI

Chief Minister said, insisting that the government would take action to prevent such accidents.

He also announced ₹5 lakh as compensation to the family of each person killed in the accident.

Soon after the accident, angry locals stopped operations at the Nazirakhat toll plaza (the accident site is close to it).

Gogoi criticises BJP

Congress MP Gaurav Gogoi also criticised the condition of Assam’s national highways, alleging that the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government has been collecting tolls while failing to provide safe roads.

Mr Gogoi also said taxpayers’ money was being wasted through a “Minister-contractor nexus”.

BJP leader’s online posts spark buzz; signs of ‘imminent’ poll shocker for ruling party: Cong

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Former Union Minister of State and senior Bharatiya Janata Party leader Kaushal Kishore’s cryptic online posts sparked a political buzz on Tuesday, with the Opposition Congress interpreting the remarks as a sign of the ruling party’s defeat in the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly poll.

“When any organisation or movement deviates from its values, it ends up back where it started, and the faith of those associated with its ideology is also shattered. Therefore, one should not deviate from its values,” Mr. Kishore said in a post on X.

The remark came a day after he wrote on X about a conversation with a friend who told him that “the ball has gone as high as it could go and it is coming down”.



BJP leader Kaushal Kishore

The online post added that the speed of its descent would increase and “no one can reduce the speed of the ball falling”.

‘Clear hint’

The comments drew a response from the Congress, with senior party leader and former State party president Ajay Kumar Lallu interpreting the “ball coming down” remark as a sign of the BJP’s defeat in the upcoming Assembly poll.

“Kaushal Kishoreji did not take anyone’s name, but the hint is so clear. The ball that was continuously thrown upward over the past few years with slogans of development, Vishwaguru, Amrit Kaal, and a strong government has now started coming down,” Mr. Lallu told *The Hindu* in Lucknow.

‘Not coincidence’

The Congress leader added that amid inflation, unemployment, concerns of farmers and youth, economic challenges and growing questions from the public, the BJP leader’s remarks could not be merely a coincidence.

“The truth is, it is not just the ball that is coming down, but the entire game is about to change, and the people of the country have made up their minds,” Mr. Lallu said.

Mother runs marathon barefoot to help fund daughters’ education

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

A 47-year-old woman, who works as a cook, won a marathon in Ambajogai region of Maharashtra’s Beed district to help fund her the education of her two daughters. A video of her feat recently went viral, in which she was seen running barefoot in a sari, holding her sandals in the hand.

The woman has been identified as Ramabai Ranveer, a native of Beed, located in Marathawada region. She is the sole breadwinner of her family ever since her husband died. “I wanted to win... that was all I had on my mind. I will buy books and



Ramabai Ranveer taking part in the marathon in Maharashtra’s Beed. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

fulfil other needs of my children. I run every day for my children’s future... today I ran for myself and children,” she said.

The marathon was organised on August 29 from Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Chowk to Bhagyanagar Chowk, a distance of around 3 km.

M.P. CM hints at renaming Jahangir Mahal

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11 Bills passed in Haryana Assembly as Monsoon Session ends

The final forensic report is awaited, the police said, adding that a supplementary chargesheet will be filed after the investigation is completed, and more people could come under the ambit of the probe.

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KSRTC/2026-27/IND0338	Procurement of Envelop and Curing Bags	2.00	05.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0339	Procurement of Diesel Particulate filter (DPF) cleaning machine for maintenance of BS VI buses	0.35	05.10.2026
KSRTC/2026-27/IND0340	Installation of High Speed Diesel Consumer Pump Facilities and supply of High Speed Diesel for (three years)	17144.00	05.10.2026
SHORT TERM TENDER			
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Sd/- CONTROLLER OF STORES & PURCHASES (Tender Inviting Authority)			
DIPR/CP/2525/MAA/2026-27			

Private hospitals halt Ayushman services over unpaid dues

Meanwhile, a State Health Department official disputed the IMA's claim, saying Ayushman services continued to function normally. "IMA representatives have been invited for discussions with Manoj Kumar, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the State's Ayushman Health Protection Authority, on Wednesday," the official added.

Inclined to cancel Shiv Sena corporator's bail in assault case, says SC

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and Augustine George Masih was hearing Mr. Mhatre's plea challenging the Bombay High Court's July 18 order staying the bail granted to him by a trial court, as well as its Au-

THE  HINDU

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Mumbai
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INBRIEF



Byelections to 38 local body wards in Keralam on Sept. 28

Byelections to 38 local body wards in Keralam will be held on September 28, State Election Commissioner N. Seshadrinathan has said. Following the announcement, the Model Code of Conduct took effect in respective jurisdictions. The election notification will be issued on September 3. The polled votes will be counted on September 29. These are the first bypolls to local body wards after the Congress-led UDF government came to power in Keralam in May.

Keralam MLA gets 1-year jail term in cheque bounce case

A court in Mumbai on Tuesday sentenced Pala MLA and United Democratic Front leader Mani C. Kappan to one year’s imprisonment and directed him to pay ₹1.20 crore as compensation in an alleged cheque-bounce case related to shares in the Kannur International Airport. The case follows a complaint filed by Mumbai-based businessman Dinesh Menon. Mr. Kappan was unavailable for a comment. Sources close to the MLA said he would appeal against the verdict.

Telangana raises ₹2,000 crore in market borrowings

The Telangana government has raised market borrowings of ₹2,000 crore to meet immediate financial commitments. The amount has been raised in three tranches through price auction of State government securities by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) at an interest rate of 7.7%. The amount, according to RBI, is the reissue of securities of July 1 which had been kept on hold. The reissue follows the fresh indent submitted by the State.

Rifles, pistols stolen from Secunderabad Army base

Over 1,800 rounds of ammunition, night-vision binocular, and 21 magazines missing from facility; online classes advised for schools in cantonment area; Army, police initiate separate investigations

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

A theft of service weapons and ammunition from an Army establishment in Secunderabad, Telangana, has put the cantonment area on high alert, with schools advised to conduct classes online and defence organisations issuing alerts asking personnel to remain vigilant.

As per the FIR, 12 firearms, including four AK-203 assault rifles, an IN-SAS rifle, six 9 mm pistols and a civilian 6.35-bore pistol, were reported missing from the 20 Madras Regiment premises at Bolla-



Security risk: Missing items include AK-203 rifles and 9 mm pistols. A view of the Secunderabad Cantonment Board office. NAGARA GOPAL

rum. A passive night-vision binocular, 21 magazines, and more than 1,800 rounds of ammunition were also found missing.

The theft came to light at about 7.50 a.m. on Monday, when Army personnel

cibly broken. The total value of the stolen property has been estimated at about ₹15 lakh.

The Army sought urgent police action to trace and recover the weapons and ammunition and identify those responsible.

The Army has also initiated a detailed internal inquiry to establish the circumstances leading to the loss. The FIR records the concern that the missing service weapons could be unauthorisedly possessed, moved or misused.

The Bollaram police registered a case under Sections 331(4) and 305 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and have initiated probe.

Expert panel begins safety evaluation of Mullaperiyar Dam

The Hindu Bureau
IDUKKI

A panel of multidisciplinary experts are undertaking a comprehensive safety evaluation of the Mullaperiyar Dam, and will submit its report within two weeks, according to Balraj Joshi, chairman of the study, and a former CMD of the National Hydro Electric Power Corporation.

Speaking to presspersons after visiting the dam

on Tuesday at Thekkady, the chairman noted that the panel is conducting an impartial, comprehensive safety evaluation. “The panel is evaluating whether this structure fulfils its intended purpose, whether it is stable, and if it ensures general public safety and structural integrity,” Mr Joshi said.

The safety evaluation is being conducted following directives from the Supreme Court.

Karnataka Parks Bill to be reviewed again in Assembly, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Tuesday said the controversial amendment that allows alienation of up to 5% of park and garden land for public infrastructure could be reviewed and discussed again in the State Legislature Assembly.

The Karnataka Government Parks (Preservation) (Amendment) Bill, 2026,

was passed in both Houses of the Legislature on August 24. The Bill aims to facilitate the tunnel road project to take over an acre of Lalbagh land, sources said. Environmental groups, citizen organisations and members of Opposition parties have opposed the Bill.

Responding to questions, Mr. Shivakumar said, “No one needs to worry. The decision will be in public interest.”

HC seeks Centre’s reply on maternity policy for athletes

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday sought the response of the Centre, the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) and the Indian Olympic Association on a petition by wrestler Vinesh Phogat, seeking a structured framework to facilitate the return of women athletes to competitive sports after pregnancy and maternity leave.

Next hearing on Nov. 18 Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma issued the notice on the plea and listed the matter for further hearing on November 18.

Senior advocate Rajshekhar Rao, appearing for Ms. Phogat, said: “This is a larger question on lady athletes and maternity leave and impact on their ability to participate in the sport”.

He pointed out that international standards provide certain benefits and protection of rankings to athletes who take maternity leave.

In the plea, Ms. Phogat sought directions for the formulation of a fair and structured framework for women athletes returning from maternity, transparent and objectively verifiable selection and nomination processes, as well as an alternative mechanism for athletes disadvantaged by maternity-related absences.

Ms. Phogat contended that after resuming her wrestling career, she was required to re-enter the



Vinesh Phogat

competitive pathway without any accommodations for the period during which she could not compete due to maternity.

According to the plea, the eligibility criteria relied on performances in tournaments held during her maternity period, effectively penalising her for an absence over which she had no control, instead of providing an alternative route for her return to competition.

WFI notice

Ms. Phogat has also challenged two show-cause notices issued by the WFI and the disciplinary proceedings initiated against her. The court asked the WFI’s counsel to obtain instructions on the matter and listed the challenge to the notices for hearing on September 29.

WFI’s counsel submitted that the federation had given Ms. Phogat two opportunities for a hearing but there had been “no show”.

A final opportunity had now been granted and the hearing was scheduled for September 2, the counsel said.

Well water a key risk factor for amoebic infections, study finds

C. Maya
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Exposure to natural water bodies and use of non-chlorinated water for bathing and other domestic purposes were significant risk factors for Amoebic Meningoencephalitis (AME), the first joint field-level study by the Keralam government and the ICMR to describe the epidemiology of AME cases that were reported in Keralam last year has found.

“Our study results showed that people using well water for bathing or washing face had 2.95 times higher odds of getting AME,” said R. Aravind, Head of Infectious Diseases, Thiruvananthapuram Government Medical College and one of the key researchers of the study.

“The estimated population attributable fraction (PAF) was 34.2%. This means that 34.2% of the cases of AME caused by Acanthamoeba in the population would not occur, if non-chlorinated well water, as a specific risk factor, was removed,” Dr. Aravind added.

Dependence on wells

Many households in Kerala depend on individual or public wells. Heavy rainfall, flooding, sewage contamination, organic matter, and algal growth might contribute to contamination or proliferation of free-living amoeba (FLAs) in poorly maintained wells.

The study, ‘Epidemiology of and Risk Factors for Amoebic Meningoencephalitis, Kerala 2025’, analysed 159 AME cases.

Carved legacy



A 200-year-old chariot at the Moorusavira Math in Hubballi, Karnataka, is now on public display after the old structure of the Math was demolished. The traditional wooden chariot features intricately carved figures and panels depicting human forms and deities. KIRAN BAKALE

CPI(M) criticises UDF over full rendition of Vande Mataram

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The full rendition of *Vande Mataram* was sung twice during the National Sports Day celebrations organised by Kerala University on Tuesday. Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar and State Ministers were among those present on the stage.

According to university officials, the National Song *Vande Mataram* was included in the programme following a specific instruction from the Governor’s office in view of his participation in the event. The song was performed in its entirety at the beginning of the programme and was

repeated at its conclusion. Sports Minister O.J. Janeesh, who attended the event, said he understood that a protocol existed when the Governor attended an official function. He indicated that the inclusion of *Vande Mataram* was connected with that protocol.

However, the CPI(M) targeted the Congress-led UDF government, with party State secretary M.V. Govindan claiming that *Vande Mataram* was a ‘Hindu song’ when rendered in full and could not be considered a secular composition. He also alleged a “deal” between Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan and the RSS.

As hyacinth chokes Vembanad, robots come to the rescue of Kumarakom

Hiran Unnikrishnan
KOTTAYAM

From handicrafts to compost, water hyacinth has found a range of uses. But its relentless spread across Vembanad Lake continues to overwhelm Kumarakom, Keralam, prompting the backwater destination to turn to technology in a bid to bring the invasive weed under control.

Starting September 10, the village will host a one-month pilot project that will deploy a robotic system to harvest water hyacinth from the lake and explore ways of processing the weed into value-added products. The initiative is being launched by the State Wetland Authority Kerala in association with



Choked up: Boats stuck in water hyacinth on Vembanad Lake in Kumarakom. VISHNU PRATHAP

stakeholders, including the Chamber of Vembanad Hotels and Resorts.

Led by the Centre for Water Resources Development and Management (CWRDM), the project will seek to turn harvested water hyacinth into value-added products for market-

ing through local channels. The Kochi-based Foundation for Environmental Research and Innovation (FERI) will serve as the implementing agency. The pilot will deploy an unmanned surface vehicle equipped with a robotic mechanism to collect wa-

YSRCP went to court against local polls fearing defeat: CM

T. Appala Naidu
MOGALTHUR

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu has said that the YSRCP has moved the court to postpone local body elections until the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of votes is done, as it is scared of an ‘absolute majority’ for the NDA, hinted by recent surveys.

“The NDA won the 2024 Assembly election with an absolute majority. All the recent surveys have suggested a similar trend for the NDA in the local body elections, sending waves of fear through the YSRCP,” Mr. Naidu said while addressing a gathering during the ‘Pedala Sevalo’ pro-



Chandrababu Naidu interacting with beneficiaries of welfare schemes at Narsapuram.

gramme at Mogalthur in West Godavari district on Tuesday.

Referring to YSRCP president Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy’s warning to his party cadre about the possibility of unanimous local body elections, Mr. Naidu

said; “What can you (Mr. Jagan) do if people opt for unanimous elections in the local body polls? The government encourages the unanimous mode of elections as it wishes unity and peace.”

The local body elections are not fought on the symbol of the political parties to ensure peace and harmony, he added.

The Chief Minister said that moving the court seeking postponement of local body elections sets a bad precedent. “Moreover, the State will be at a loss if the local body elections are not conducted. The eligibility for grants from the Finance Commission will not be met if the polls are delayed,” Mr. Naidu said.

Cong. weighs action against senior leaders in Telangana

R. Ravikanth Reddy
HYDERABAD

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy met AICC general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal in New Delhi on Tuesday amid indications that the Congress leadership is weighing disciplinary action against Minister Konda Surekha and senior leader G. Chinnna Reddy.

The meeting is understood to have focussed on Ms. Surekha and the recent developments surrounding her. The issue concerning Mr. Chinnna Reddy also came up. His remarks on money in ticket distribution are understood to have caused concern.



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No.DGM-01/BSWML/TEND/13/2026-27 **Date: 01.09.2026**

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2	Providing and Construction of SSM with Chainlink Fencing Compound for Gollahalli Sy.No.58 in Bengaluru South Constituency Cal-3 .	520.17	Rs.1,00,000/- through e-payment under of the following i.e., online / RTGS / NEFT / OTC and the balance Rs.6,80,255/- by Bank Guarantee/FDR issued by Nationalized / Scheduled Bank	06 Months (Including Monsoon Period)

1) Last date to upload pre-bid queries in kpp portal: **07.09.2026 before 4:00 hrs.** 2) Tender Pre Bid meeting: **08.09.2026 at 16:00 hrs** at BSWML office. 3) Last Date of Receipt of Tender **17.09.2026 before 16:00 hrs.** 4) Opening of Technical Bid: **18.09.2026 after 16:30 hrs.**

More details can be downloaded from website - <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

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ENTERPRISE CONNECT		BUSINESS INSIGHTS
Punjab National Bank signs MoU with Oriental Insurance Company Limited for Providing Salary Package Benefits to Oriental Insurance Employees  Punjab National Bank has entered into Memorandum of Understanding(MoU) for Salary Package Benefits with Oriental Insurance Company Limited(OICL). PNB is offering bouquet of services with enhanced Insurance Coverage, Banking Benefits, Concessional offers in Retail Loans and Other Benefits to all the serving employees of OICL. The MoU was signed by Shri Chhotu Ram, General Manager (HR & Estate) on behalf of OICL and Shri Sudhir Dalal, Chief General Manager(BA&RM) on behalf of PNB. The offering provides OICL employees and their families with comprehensive insurance protection and a host of enhanced banking privileges, including dedicated education and marriage-related covers for children. Key benefits include preferential locker rent, salary-linked overdraft facilities, zero-balance family accounts, complimentary essential banking services, and concessions on processing and documentation charges for home, education and vehicle loans. Speaking on the occasion, Shri Ashok Chandra, MD&CEO, PNB said "The signing of this MoU marks an important milestone in strengthening the relationship between two leading Public Sector organizations in the financial sector. This partnership reflects our shared commitment towards providing enhanced value and a comprehensive bouquet of banking services to the employees of OICL. Anondita Medicare Limited Receives NSE In-Principle Approval for Rights Issue Aggregating Up to ₹10,978.20 Lakhs Anondita Medicare Limited has announced the receipt of in-principle approval from the NSE for its proposed Rights Issue. The approval was granted by the NSE vide letter reference No. NSE/LIST/C/2026/0866 dated August 25, 2026. Upon receipt of this in-principle approval, the Company is permitted to issue and allot fully paid-	up equity shares of face value of ₹10/- each on a rights basis to eligible equity shareholders, aggregating up to an amount of ₹10,978.20 lakhs, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory compliances. Commenting on the development, Mr. Anupam Ghosh, Managing Director, Anondita Medicare Limited said, "The receipt of in-principle approval from NSE is an important step in our proposed Rights Issue and in our plans for the next phase of growth. We have built a strong foundation through our manufacturing capabilities, improving operational efficiencies and expanding market presence. The proposed fund raise will provide us with additional resources as we work towards increasing our manufacturing capacity, strengthening our product portfolio and pursuing opportunities in domestic and international markets. We remain focused on building the business for sustainable growth while maintaining our emphasis on quality and compliance." REC Limited Holds 57th Annual General Meeting and launches 3rd edition of ESG report REC Limited, held its 57th Annual General Meeting (AGM) on 25th Aug '26 through Video Conferencing, providing shareholders an opportunity to be apprised of the Company's performance and key achievements during the financial year 2025-26. Addressing the shareholders, Shri Jitendra Srivastava, Chairman & Managing Director, highlighted the Company's strong financial and operational performance during FY2025-26 and its growing role as a trusted partner in India's energy transition. He said that the year marked strong performance and strategic progress for REC amid a rapidly evolving global environment, with the Company continuing to focus on growth, resilience, sustainability, transparency and strong corporate governance. During FY2025-26, REC achieved its highest-ever annual disbursements of ₹2.11 lakh crore, while sanctions rose to a record ₹4.09 lakh crore. The Company's net worth crossed ₹84,000 crore, registering around 9% year-on-year growth, while its gross loan assets stood at ₹5.84 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026. The Company recorded a net profit of ₹16,282 crore and total income of ₹59,187 crore during the year. LBSIM Hosts HR Conclave 2026 on "Human Capital in the Era of AI: Redefining Talent, Work, and Career." Lal Bahadur Shastri Institute of Management (LBSIM), Delhi,	successfully hosted HR Conclave 2026 on the theme "Human Capital in the Era of AI: Redefining Talent, Work and Career." The conclave brought together eminent academicians, HR leaders, industry professionals and students to explore the impact of Artificial Intelligence on human capital, talent, careers and the future of work. The conclave was held under the guidance and leadership of Shri Anil Shastri Chairman, Board of Governors, LBSIM, whose vision continues to inspire the Institute's commitment to developing future-ready professionals. Prof. T. V. Rao, Chief Guest and Chairperson, T V Rao Learning Systems Pvt. Ltd., emphasized the enduring importance of effort, empathy and character in an increasingly automated workplace. Mr. Akshay Rakshit, Head – Talent Acquisition & Strategy, Hyundai Motor India Ltd., described AI as a career inflection point and shared his "cake baking" framework for continuous career growth. Shri Adarsh Shastri, Member, Advisory Body, LBSIM, highlighted the importance of human imagination, curiosity, critical thinking and professional networks. Investor Interest in RIICO's Direct Allotment Scheme Continues to Rise - 954 applications received for 242 industrial plots in 13th phase1 Investor response to RIICO's Direct Allotment Scheme–2025 continues to grow, reflecting increasing confidence in Rajasthan as an industrial investment destination. In the 13th phase of the scheme, 954 online applications have been received for 242 industrial plots spread across approximately 152 acres, with an estimated value of ₹311 crore. For plots that have received multiple applications, RIICO will conduct an e-lottery on September 1, 2026. The Shri Ram Janki Industrial Area, Kunjbiharipura in Jaipur, witnessed the strongest investor response, with 659 applications for 32 plots. Applications were also received for industrial areas including Shiv (Balotra), Dhunwala (Bhilwara), Fatehpura-Sameliya (Bhilwara), Boranada Extension and Chatalia (Mandore). The Direct Allotment Scheme has completed 12 successful phases so far, through which 2,147 industrial plots have been allotted. These allotments are expected to facilitate investments of more than ₹20,500 crore and create employment opportunities for over 42,000 people. Further, the allotment process for more than 400 plots is currently underway, with the potential to attract an additional ₹1,600 crore-plus investment.

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IT IS for general information that I was previously known as Karishma Gosai, d/o Shakti Ram Gosai r/o PG Block 137, Ground Floor, Pongasgi Pur, Janakpuri B-1, West Delhi, Delhi 110058, and after being diagnosed with Gender Dysphoria under the supervision of a registered medical practitioner in New Delhi, have changed my gender to male. I henceforth be known as Krish Goshai, s/o Shakti Ram Gosai r/o PG Block 137, Ground Floor, Pongasgi Pur, Janakpuri B-1, West Delhi, Delhi 110058. It is certified that I have complied with the legal requirements in the connection, Karishma Gosai

PUBLIC NOTICE

Between:
A. VenkateswarluComplainant
And
Diamond Enterprises & othersOpposite Parties

To: Diamond Enterprises, Ground Floor, Godown Nos. 81, 82, 83 & 84, Near Kali Matha Mandir, Krishna Nagar, Malout Road, Bathinda, Punjab State.

In the above complaint the Notices were issued to you several times but could not be served. The matter is posted on **15-09-2026** at 10:30 a.m. for your appearance. You may appear personally or through an Advocate and submit your objections, if any. If you fail to appear, the Commission may proceed and pass appropriate orders as per law.

Sd/- M. Balaram
Place : Ongole, Advocate, Ongole
Date : 31.08.2026. Prakasham D A, F.

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given to the General Public that my client, **Shri Abdul Muneem, S/o Shri Abdul Muneem, R/o D-992, Village Wazirabad, New Delhi - 110009**, is the lawful Owner/Occupier of property bearing No. D-992/Previous No. 21, admeasuring 864 Sq. Yards, out of Khassa No. 1724, situated in the revenue estate of Village Wazirabad, Delhi - 110009 (hereinafter referred to as the 'said Property').

It is submitted that my client is the absolute owner of the said Property and has, at no point of time, expressed any intention or willingness to sell, transfer, alienate or otherwise part with possession of the said Property.

It has come to the knowledge of my client that certain unscrupulous persons, in collusion with one another, are attempting to deal in, negotiate, or create third-party interest in respect of the said Property on the strength of forged, fabricated or manufactured documents, which are illegal, void and have no sanctity whatsoever in the eyes of law.

It is made clear that any dealing, transaction, or agreement in respect of the said Property or Any Part Of, contrary to my client's rights, shall be void ab initio and not binding on my client. My client reserves the right to initiate civil and/or criminal proceedings against any person(s) indulging in such activities. All this shall be at the cost, risk, peril and consequence of such person(s)

Tushar Saini (Advocate)
Enrolment No. D/290/2013
Ch. No. 734, Lawyers' Chamber Block,
Saket District Court, New Delhi
Mob: 9999923242

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OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

BIRTH CENTENARY

BIRTH CENTENARY



A. SRINIVASAN
02.09.1926

Son of M. Subbulakshmi
& L. Achutha Iyer

Remembered with love,
A. Rajalakshmi
Achutha Krishnamurti
and The ACHUTHANS

REMEMBRANCE

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Mrs Visalam Anandakumar
(23.01.1935 - 02.09.2023)

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1	Tender Specification No.CCP-4/27/2026-2027								
	Cluster-A	Rudrapur, Kashipur, Haldwani, Pithoragarh	180.50 Cr.	3.61 Cr.	8.45 Lacs	29,500.00	5.9.2026 at 11:30 hrs at Victoria Cross Vijeyta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun	15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 11.30 hrs
	Cluster-B	Dehradun (Urban) Dehradun (Rural)	115.50 Cr.	2.31 Cr.	5.40 Lacs	29,500.00		15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 11.45 hrs
	Cluster-C	Tehri, Haridwar & Roorkee	206.30 Cr.	4.13 Cr.	9.63 Lacs	29,500.00		15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 12.00 hrs

For further details, please visit the website www.uktenders.gov.in

No. : 678/EE(CM)/UPCL /A-2

Date : 31.08.2026

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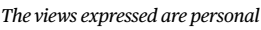
The format of application and other details are available on the DHE website i.e. <https://higheredn.delhi.gov.in/> Last date of receipt of Application is 16.10.2026. The application in the prescribed proforma in a closed cover should reach by Registered/Speed Post to:

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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Jharkhand districts in which flash flood alerts were issued

10 The Jharkhand weather department has issued a flash flood warning for 10 districts as heavy rain lashed large parts of the State on Tuesday. Dumaria in East Singhbhum registered the highest 217 mm of rain since Monday, the India Meteorological Department said. PTI

Onion stock for PDS that reached Chennai via Kanda Express

840 in tonnes. The second 'Kanda Express' — a dedicated railway rake carrying 840 tonne of onion from the buffer stock — reached Chennai on August 31, with the Tamil Nadu government planning to distribute 1 kg onion per ration card via the Public Distribution System (PDS). PTI

Number of corruption cases pending trial as of December 2025

7,229 As of December 31, 2025, a total of 7,229 corruption cases probed by the CBI were pending trial in courts, including 409 cases pending for more than 20 years, according to the Central Vigilance Commission's 2025 annual report. PTI

Keralam's monsoon rainfall deficit from June to August

22 in per cent. Keralam received 1,367.1 mm of rainfall during the southwest monsoon from June 1 to August 31, 2026, which was 22% below the normal rainfall of 1,746.8 mm, according to IMD data. Wayanad recorded the highest deficit among districts at 50 per cent, followed by Idukki at 44%. PTI

Share of asylum requests denied in the U.S. in June 2026

94.1 in per cent. U.S. immigration court data showed that 94.1% of asylum cases were denied in June 2026, while only 5.5% were granted, according to figures reported by the Transactional Records Access Clearinghouse (TRAC). PTI
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Untouchability and the idea of ‘purity’

How does Indian law define ‘untouchability’? How has the Supreme Court interpreted ‘purity and pollution’? What did the Rajasthan High Court rule on purification? What facts would determine whether the Haldwani ritual amounted to untouchability?

LETTER & SPIRIT

Sahil Hussain Chaudhury

The story so far:

A *shuddhikaran* (purification) ritual was performed at Haldwani’s Ramlila ground on August 10, two days after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge addressed a rally there. Mr. Kharge said the ritual made him feel the “sting of untouchability” and sought legal action, while the organisation that performed it offered a different explanation, citing slogans allegedly raised during the rally and Mr. Kharge’s earlier political remarks. The dispute raises a legal question beyond the immediate controversy: what does Indian law regard as untouchability when the alleged wrong is not denial of entry, but the “purification” of a place after a Dalit person has used it?

What does the law prohibit?

Article 17 of the Constitution declares that “untouchability” is abolished”, forbids its practice “in any form”, and says that enforcing any disability arising from untouchability shall be an offence punishable in accordance with law. The Supreme Court has recognised that Article 17 is enforceable against non-State actors as well.

The Constitution does not define “untouchability”.

Parliament gave effect to Article 17 through the Untouchability (Offences) Act, 1955, which was substantially amended and renamed the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 in 1976. The Act punishes the preaching and practice of untouchability and the enforcement of disabilities arising from it.

Some of its provisions address familiar forms of untouchability: preventing entry into a place of worship, imposing social disabilities, or discriminating in access to public facilities and services. But the law is not confined to physically keeping somebody out. Section 7(1)(d) also punishes a person who “insults or attempts to insult, on the ground of ‘untouchability’, a member of a



Show of dissent: Congress workers march towards the Uttarakhand Secretariat in Dehradun on Tuesday, protesting a ‘purification’ ceremony at the venue of Mallikarjun Kharge’s Haldwani rally. PTI

Scheduled Caste”.

The law can reach conduct beyond denial of access, but the fact that an act affects or humiliates a Scheduled Caste person does not by itself answer whether Section 7(1)(d) is attracted. The provision requires the insult to be “on the ground of ‘untouchability’”.

How has the Supreme Court interpreted Article 17?

The Supreme Court addressed the scope of Article 17 in *Sukanya Shantha v Union of India* (2024), while striking down caste-discriminatory provisions in prison manuals and reviewing its earlier Article 17 jurisprudence.

The court described untouchability as connected to the caste system and its interconnected notions of “purity and pollution”. These ideas, it said, have been used to reinforce caste hierarchy and influence whom people associate with and how they treat one another. Article 17 rejects such notions.

The judgment also explains why the absence of a definition does not necessarily confine the scope of Article 17. It noted that even a broadly worded definition could become restrictive because discrimination can manifest itself through the “manifold complexities” of social life. Article 17 must therefore be capable of reaching untouchability in its

different forms and manifestations.

The court then stated the principle directly: “There cannot be any stigma attached to the existence, touch or presence of any person.”

The court’s reasoning is therefore not confined to familiar forms of exclusion. It also addresses the underlying caste idea of pollution: discriminatory treatment based on a person’s touch or presence.

What has the court said about such practices?

In *Surya Narayan Choudhary v State of Rajasthan* (1988), the Rajasthan High Court considered discrimination against Dalit devotees at the public Shrinathji temple in Nathdwara.

The court was told that Dalit devotees were permitted to enter only after undergoing a process of purification.

Crucially, the High Court held that Dalit devotees could not be subjected to an additional condition for temple entry that did not apply to other devotees, and specifically directed that the reported purification practice be discontinued, holding it discriminatory and violative of Articles 14, 15 and 17.

At Nathdwara, purification was imposed on Dalit devotees before they could enter a temple on equal terms. At Haldwani, the ritual occurred after Mr. Kharge had already used the venue, and

the reason for it is disputed. The *Surya Narayan Choudhary* case therefore does not decide the present controversy; it establishes the narrower proposition that caste-specific ritual purification imposed on Dalits as a condition of equal access can violate Article 17.

Where is the legal boundary?

Article 17 and the Protection of Civil Rights Act must also be distinguished from the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, which creates separate criminal offences with their own ingredients.

Section 3(1)(r), for example, deals with intentionally insulting or intimidating an SC/ST member with intent to humiliate them in a place within public view, when committed by a person who is not an SC or ST. In *Hitesh Verma v State of Uttarakhand* (2020), the Supreme Court said that not every insult to an SC/ST person attracts the provision: the insult or intimidation must be connected to the victim belonging to the protected community. More recently, in *Gunjan @ Girija Kumari v State* (NCT of Delhi) (2026), the Supreme Court reiterated that “public view” is an essential requirement for the offence.

What would establish untouchability?

If evidence were to show that the venue was regarded as requiring cleansing because caste-based notions of pollution were attached to Mr. Kharge’s touch or presence, the reasoning in *Sukanya Shantha* case and the caste-specific purification considered in *Surya Narayan Choudhary* case would become directly relevant. If, on the other hand, the ritual was undertaken for reasons unconnected with caste, including the reasons cited by the organisers, its timing after Mr. Kharge’s rally would not by itself establish untouchability.

The word *shuddhikaran* cannot answer that question. The legal issue is the connection, if any, between the ritual and caste-based notions of pollution. (*Sahil Hussain Choudhury is an advocate and Constitutional law researcher from Assam*)

THE GIST

Article 17 abolishes untouchability in all forms, while the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 penalises its practice, including insults based on untouchability.

The Supreme Court has linked untouchability to caste-based notions of ‘purity and pollution’, holding that Article 17 can address different forms of discriminatory treatment based on a person’s touch or presence.

Whether the Haldwani ritual amounts to untouchability would depend on evidence of a caste-based connection; the word ‘*shuddhikaran*’ or the ritual’s timing alone would not establish it.

What does Thailand’s new amnesty Act cover?

Who would benefit from the new Act? What are the shortcomings of the amnesty push?

Vighnesh P. Venkitesh

The story so far:

Thailand’s Peaceful Society Promotion Act, an amnesty initiative passed by lawmakers in July, came into effect on August 24, as the government under Prime Minister Anutin Charnvirakul seeks reconciliation with a large share of the population still leaning towards populist former leader Thaksin Shinawatra, a key figure at the centre of the country’s political turmoil.

What are the provisions of the new Act?

The Act seeks to grant amnesty to those convicted over protests or for “expressions motivated by political conflicts” from January 1, 2005, to July 16, 2025, except for offences involving corruption, lese majeste violations,

murder or causing serious injuries, and those against private entities on a case-by-case basis.

The Act has listed more than 40 categories of offences eligible for amnesty, including severe charges such as sedition, rebellion, cybercrimes and emergency violations.

The Act calls for the setting up of a committee, the “peaceful society promotion committee”, led by the Prime Minister or his deputy within a month to determine who qualifies for amnesty. The panel will have representatives from Parliament, human rights experts, and civil society organisation members.

In addition to granting release for current prisoners, the committee can also close investigations and prosecutions, dismiss pending court cases, and clear criminal records of those eligible for the amnesty. Government officials have said that the panel will review all political

cases recorded between 2005 and 2025 under the Act.

Who would benefit from the new Act?

The Thai Lawyers for Human Rights says that more than 5,000 individuals have been prosecuted for political conflicts since the 2006 coup, with a third of these happening after 2020, with around 300 of those involved being under the age of 18.

It said that, as of July this year, around 54 people remained in prison over political activities, but only around 10 of them would be eligible for amnesty since the others have Article 112 charges against them.

Other than those in prison, the Act would also clear the records of thousands with charges. This includes members of pro-Shinawatra bodies and anti-monarchy outfits as well as the royalists who took part in the ‘yellow shirt’ protests in 2006 that led to the coup and subsequent

ouster of Mr. Shinawatra and years of instability.

The current Bhumjaithai Party-led government, which came to power after a snap election following a short term as a minority government, is on thin ice, having to manage strong voices from multiple political alignments in the country, and the sweeping amnesty provisions, which can be interpreted for the pro-democracy outfits as well as the royalists simultaneously, is a strategic move to secure support.

What are the shortcomings of the amnesty push?

While the new Act will erase politically motivated criminal records for thousands of people, several organisations have questioned the exclusion of lese majeste provisions from its ambit. The draconian Article 112, critics say, has been used to silence dissent by governments, including the royalists and the populists, with even juveniles being charged and awaiting trial for defaming the King and senior officials of the royalty.

While the Act has listed sedition and rebellion as charges eligible for amnesty consideration, Section 112 remained non-negotiable during lawmakers’ deliberation. A minority faction of independent Senators had moved during the drafting period of the legislation to introduce a clause to grant amnesty for

Section 112 convicts under 18 years of age at the time of the offense, but this was set aside in a 126 to 15 vote.

Critics say that the new Act also has a provision explicitly stipulating that even the existing special rehabilitation and judicial diversion plans for minors cannot be applied to any youth facing a Section 112 charge. This ensures that the law serves as a “blunt instrument of absolute exclusion, stripping young pro-democracy activists of the legal protections normally afforded to children under both domestic and international human rights frameworks”, 112watch, a Thai organisation, said.

The legislation shows that political reconciliation in Thailand is “selective, conditional, and reserved only for favoured factions”, the organisation said in a statement condemning its clearance. “Excluding Article 112 – a provision historically used as a political weapon to suppress dissent – does not foster national harmony; it deepens societal wounds and institutionalises state impunity”, it said.

The group has also flagged the insertion of offences related to election fraud into the scope of amnesty under the Act, which could potentially clear individuals involved in collusion during senatorial elections, which is not related to the political expression that the government seeks to look beyond.

CACHE

India’s data centre boom is colliding with its climate reality

India’s data centre expansion is attracting billions in investment, but rising electricity and water demand, transmission bottlenecks, heat generation are straining already stressed resources; a national framework with enforceable standards is needed to manage these costs and protect consumers

Soumya Sarkar

India is in the middle of a data centre gold rush. Global tech giants – Google, Meta, Amazon, Microsoft – have committed billions to build facilities across the country. The government estimates that data centres will drive nearly \$200 billion in investment over the coming decade.

Many States in the country are competing fiercely for a piece of the pie. Maharashtra wants to be the data centre capital of the country. Telangana has declared data centres as “essential services.” Karnataka is reviewing its policy to attract more. Rajasthan is offering tax exemptions and cheap land. All eyes are on the opportunity, but none on the cost.

Data centre capacity in India has nearly tripled from 520 megawatts in 2020 to nearly 1.5 gigawatts today. By 2030, it is projected to hit 6.5 GW, which is a fourfold expansion in just four years. Electricity demand from these facilities is expected to rise from about 13 terawatt-hours (TWh) in 2024 to roughly 57 TWh by 2030. The Union Ministry of Power estimates that artificial intelligence alone will add 26.3 gigawatts of new demand by 2031-32.

No policy document, at the Central or State level, has assessed what guaranteed power costs the grid that is already strained under 45°C heat, or where the water will come from for cooling, or what the thermal load from thousands of servers will do to regions already teetering on dangerously high temperatures.

The resource reality

A 100 MW data centre consumes about 2 million litres of water daily. That is equivalent to the daily use of roughly 6,500 households. India’s data centres consumed an estimated 150 billion litres of water in 2024-25. By 2030, that figure is projected to more than double to 358 billion litres annually.

The water use matters because data centres are clustering in India’s most water-stressed regions. Rajasthan extracts 147.11% of its annual groundwater recharge, the second highest rate in the country. Several groundwater assessment units in Maharashtra are classified as semi-critical. Telangana’s Irrigation Minister confirmed in May 2026 that 16 districts were under groundwater stress. Hyderabad’s surface water supply dropped 20% during the summer of 2024 due to poor monsoon recharge, forcing the water board to ration supply. Mumbai’s reservoirs stood at just 44.5% of capacity in March 2026.

The water these facilities consume is not accounted for in any State policy. None of the policies require public disclosure of daily water consumption. None require a hydrogeological assessment before approval. None mandate that water sourcing must not compete with agriculture or municipal supply.

The electricity situation is equally concerning. India’s power grid is already straining under record demand. Maharashtra’s peak power demand hit 27,230 MW in April 2026, the highest ever handled by the State utility. Two-year waits for 220 kV grid interconnections across the country are already lengthening project timelines.

Transmission constraints are also



GETTY IMAGES

becoming a critical bottleneck. India curtailed 300 GW-hours of renewable energy in the first quarter of 2026 alone, simply because the grid could not carry it, according to an analysis of Central Electricity Authority data by Ember Energy, a specialised consultancy. Over the past five years, India has met only about 80% of its annual transmission targets. One in four major transmission schemes is running a year or more behind schedule. As a result, 20 GW of renewable energy capacity faces connectivity delays of more than four months.

Rajasthan and Gujarat, which house the bulk of India’s utility-scale solar and wind, face the longest queues at pooling stations. The problem has become structural in the country. Solar projects are being built faster than the wires to carry their power. This matters because data centres need reliable, uninterrupted electricity. If renewable energy cannot reach them, the power will come from coal, adding to the burden of carbon emissions that India is trying to curtail.

The heat they generate

Data centres do not just consume power and water. They also generate heat. And that heat makes the places around them hotter. A March 2026 study from the University of Cambridge, analysing 20 years of NASA satellite data, found that data centres raise land surface temperatures by an average of 2°C within a 10 km radius, with extreme cases reaching 9.1°C. The study estimates that approximately 340 million people globally live within these affected zones.

This is not a distant problem. Mumbai’s land surface temperature has already risen from 40.9°C in 2003 to 47.3°C in 2023, an increase driven largely by urbanisation and heat-trapping infrastructure. Hyderabad’s urban heat island intensity ranges from 5.74°C to

6.82°C, even as its urban area doubled between 2001 and 2020. The city recorded temperatures above 43°C in the summer of 2024.

The Cambridge finding creates a feedback loop. Data centres generate heat. That heat raises ambient temperatures. Higher ambient temperatures increase cooling demand. Increased cooling demand raises electricity consumption. Higher electricity consumption, unless fully renewable, increases emissions. And those emissions contribute to the very climate change that is making India hotter in the first place.

The governance gap

The data centre policies of various States offer generous incentives in the form of electricity duty exemptions, transmission charge waivers, stamp duty relief, and fast-track clearances. But they impose virtually no conditions. None of the major State policies require a grid impact assessment before commissioning. None require mandatory renewable energy sourcing. None require thermal load assessment for surrounding communities.

Telangana’s policy is particularly revealing. It classifies data centres as “essential services,” guaranteeing them uninterrupted power even during shortages. In a State where 16 districts face groundwater stress and temperatures have reached 47°C, this is a policy choice with direct consequences.

Maharashtra’s policy originally required 100% renewable energy for core operations. In June 2026, the State reduced that requirement to 51%, a dilution framed as improving project viability.

Gujarat’s new Data Centre Policy 2026-29 mandates at least 51% green energy sourcing. Karnataka’s IT minister told the State Assembly in March 2026

that the State was reviewing its policy over water and energy concerns. Tamil Nadu has linked incentives to renewable compliance. But these are exceptions, not the norm. And even where mandates exist, enforcement and verification remain weak.

“There is a risk that a significant part of the associated infrastructure cost could eventually be socialised,” said Vibhuti Garg, Director, South Asia at the Institute for Energy Economics and Financial Analysis (IEEFA), a think tank. “Where broader grid infrastructure is required, government support or appropriate financing mechanisms could help ensure that the cost is not simply transferred to consumers through higher electricity tariffs.”

“Governments should introduce phased power and water use standards with enforceable benchmarks,” said Prateek Aggarwal, Senior Programme Lead at Council on Energy, Environment and Water, a Delhi-based think tank. “A national AI Energy Star rating would let buyers and regulators compare how energy-efficient a facility or model actually is.”

What needs to change

India’s generation pipeline can absorb the additional demand from data centres. The Union Ministry of Power says capacity is not the constraint. The constraint is market design and transmission infrastructure.

Aggarwal argued that “India needs climate-intelligent power markets that price grid services separately, where short-term markets pay for ramping, storage, and demand response.” Ember’s analysis points to another near-term solution in the form of battery storage at renewable pooling stations. Roughly 3-4 GW of two-hour storage could have absorbed most of the curtailed generation in early 2026, according to its calculations. The technical pieces are in place but the gap is regulatory and commercial.

IEEFA has suggested that coastal locations offer advantages such as proximity to near-shore wind and solar, and access to seawater for cooling without desalination. But for now, most data centres are clustering around existing tech hubs of Mumbai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru, and the National Capital Region. These are precisely the places where water and grid stress are already most acute.

A national sustainability framework would help. It would establish minimum standards for renewable energy sourcing, water consumption disclosure, grid impact assessment, and thermal load evaluation. It would create a common set of expectations for investors and a common set of protections for consumers. It would also recognise that environmental constraints are economic constraints, and that ignoring them only creates larger costs later.

Data centres are not optional. They are critical infrastructure for India’s digital future. The question is not whether India should build them. The data centres will be built. It remains to be seen whether they will be built in a way that protects India’s water, power grid and climate, or in a way that leaves future generations to pay the bill. (Soumya Sarkar is an independent journalist based in New Delhi and Kolkata)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the difference between “resume” and “biodata”? (Mootha Sarva Rayudu, Kakinada)

It is difficult to point out the difference between the two. In the Indian context, I guess one could say that there is no difference between them. A “bio-data” is a resume. A native speaker, on the other hand, may not understand what you mean by “bio-data”. The word does not exist in most native varieties of English. The words commonly used by native speakers are CV (curriculum vitae) and resume. In India, however, the word ‘bio-data’ is much more common than the other two.

Is ‘juggernaut’ derived from Lord Jagannath? (S. Bakthavathsalan, Gurgaon, Haryana)

Yes, Lord Jagannath of Puri has given us the word “juggernaut”. As you probably know, Lord Jagannath and his consort are usually placed on huge chariots and taken out in procession every year. Lots of people from various parts of the country come to see and participate in this event. Many people line up as volunteers to pull the heavy chariot. Whenever you have a huge crowd, accidents are very commonplace; they are just waiting to happen. There have been several reported cases of people accidentally falling and being crushed by the huge wheels of Lord Jagannath’s chariot. A person who was a witness to such accidents was a Franciscan missionary named Friar Odoric. He visited India in the 14th Century and wrote about his visit to Puri in a journal, which he published in Europe later on. In his journal, Odoric wrote in detail about the huge chariot of Jagannath and how the devotees threw themselves at the chariot wheels, allowing themselves to be crushed. According to Odoric, the people were offering themselves as a sacrifice to the Lord! The European readers were shocked and horrified when they read this, and began to associate the word “juggernaut” with a huge object that is out of control. The Friar’s story of the human sacrifice spread throughout Europe and by the 19th Century “juggernaut” began to be associated with a massive object that destroyed everything in its path. It was seen as a destructive force. It is interesting to note that “trains”, “tanks”, and even “automobiles”, when they were first introduced, were referred to as “juggernauts”! The word has a negative connotation in English. Here are a few examples.

Sandeep is very naive. He thinks it is possible to compete with the juggernauts of the industry.

Believe it or not, the skinny man standing over there is a political juggernaut.

What is the meaning of “cut off one’s nose to spite one face”? (Pranjal Kishore Sharmah, Jorhat, Assam)

This is one of those expressions that has been around for quite some time. If you wanted to get even with someone, or hurt the feelings of that person, would you do it by cutting off your nose? Would that be a sensible thing to do? It wouldn’t, would it? That’s what the expression ‘cut off one’s nose to spite one’s face’ means. It means harming oneself, perhaps much more than the person one is trying to hurt.

Harish loves to play tennis, but he refused to play with Suresh because he doesn’t like him. He was cutting off his nose to spite his face.”
Published in The Hindu on October 30, 2001

Word of the day

Lacuna:

a blank gap or missing part

Synonyms: shortage, lack, deficiency, paucity, absence, scarcity

Usage: *There is a lacuna in the report that needs to be addressed.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/lacuna

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ləˈkjuːnə/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

THE DAILY QUIZ

On September 2, 1946, an interim government headed by Jawaharlal Nehru began functioning as British India took its first major step towards the transfer of power

Prathmesh Kher

QUESTION 1

Which British constitutional initiative provided the framework for the formation of the interim government?

QUESTION 2

Who served as Commander-in-Chief of India while the interim government was in operation?

QUESTION 3

On what date did the Muslim League join the interim government?

QUESTION 4

Through what electoral mechanism were members of the Constituent Assembly, from which the interim government was formed, chosen?

QUESTION 5

On what date did the interim government cease to exist, and what major constitutional event brought its tenure to an end?



Visual Question:

Identify these members of the interim government from left to right. SELECTED WORKS OF JAWAHARLAL NEHRU, SECOND SERIES, VOL. 1, PP. 160–161

Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz:

1. Who was the first Indian to win the Magsaysay Award as early as 1958? **Ans: Vinoba Bhave**
2. Who won the award in 1965 for public service? What was the title that he was known by? **Ans: Jayaprakash Narayan; Lok Nayak**
3. Name the Indian who won the award in 1974. Name the last and most prominent film featuring her? **Ans: M.S. Subbulakshmi. Meera**
4. Another award winner in 2005, this person was born into a family that had two distinguished Nobel laureates. She served as a

leading doctor and director of the Cancer Institute in Chennai. **Ans: V. Shanta**
5. A former IAS officer, this awardee led major campaigns, the most prominent of which was the National Campaign for the People’s Right to Information, which culminated in the Right to Information Act being passed. **Ans: Aruna Roy**
Visual: Identify this awardee. Cited for “guiding the people of [Andhra Pradesh] to end the scourge of child labour and send all of their children to school”. **Ans: Shantha Sinha**
Early Birds: Siddhartha Viswanathan | Piyaali Tuli | Tamal Biswas | Sunil Madhavan | Lalchand Bhutani

From Page One

Top court quashes FIRs against Gen Z protesters

The top court said the Centre would be at liberty to ensure that States and Union Territories did not register any fresh FIRs with respect to the CJP-led protests held between July 20 and July 25. Kerala, represented by advocate Aljo Joseph, appreciated the court’s decision, saying that police did not respond with violence to the student protests held in the State.

‘Frame compensation policy’

It further directed the Centre to frame a pan-India policy for compensating the families of students who took their own lives following the NEET-UG 2026 paper leaks, and then make the payments within three months.

The hour-long hearing ended in a general round of bonhomie with Chief Justice Kant light-heartedly saying, “All of us have seen student life.” The CJT’s oral remarks about ‘cockroaches’ and ‘parasites’ in the same court room had sparked the advent of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

The CJL, after pronouncing the order, advised that students must “concentrate on careers to establish and create a space in a competitive world”. The court said it chose to invoke Article 142, primarily keeping in mind the “future prospects of the young protestors”.

“As an institution, we are thankful a constructive environment has been created that will help youngsters. All the best wishes,” Chief Justice Kant said, giving expression to an air of satisfaction prevalent in the court room.

The CJP co-convenor, who read out a statement from his mobile phone after being invited to the front row to address the Bench, said that, “in view of the positive assurances of the Government of India [to close the FIRs] and the judicial sanctity bestowed upon them today... the CJP deems it appropriate to withdraw the call for the march on September 5 and looks forward to compliance with today’s order.”

SCO must dismantle terror ecosystem: PM

“We must dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorist financing, recruitment, radicalisation, and safe havens. We must speak with one voice and make it clear that there can be no place for double standards on this serious issue. We must send a strong message to countries that use terrorism as an instrument of policy and provide safe haven and support to terrorists that terrorism can never be a strategic asset for anyone,” the Prime Minister said.

Referring to the situation in Afghanistan, Mr. Modi described drug trafficking as a threat to regional security. “Our shared aspiration for a peaceful and secure Eurasia is also closely linked to peace and stability in Afghanistan. India has been contributing to the development and provision of humanitarian assistance to the people of Afghanistan and will continue to do so,” he said.

The Bishkek Declaration urged the Taliban administration in Kabul to create an “inclusive government with the participation of all ethnopolitical groups in Afghanistan” to ensure lasting peace in the country.

Reflecting the SCO’s collective position on the situation in the Persian Gulf, Mr. Modi said the crisis in West Asia has affected “energy security, maritime security and supply chain[s]”, noting that the nations of the Global South were “bearing the greatest brunt of such disruptions”.

The Bishkek Declaration addressed both the U.S.-Iran conflict and the Ukraine-Russia war by saying that the actions of “certain countries” or groups of countries that unilaterally deploy global missile defence systems negatively impact international security.

NCLT Special Bench stays relief to Chandra

A two-member Bench of the NCLT in New Delhi had delivered a split verdict on the repayment plan in September 2025. Following the split ruling, Nilesh Sharma was brought in as the third member to resolve the impasse, who delivered the August 25 ruling.

In his ruling, Mr. Sharma backed the repayment plan approved by creditors holding 80.814% of the voting share. The plan required Mr. Chandra to pay ₹6.25 crore from his personal estate against admitted claims of ₹22,006.57 crore, effectively entailing a haircut of over 99% for dissenting creditors, including major banks and financial institutions.

However, when the matter returned to the original two-member Bench, it found that Mr. Sharma had “consciously passed an independent order” rather than concurring with either of the earlier opinions, leaving no majority view.

This prompted a fresh reference to the NCLT President Justice Anupinder Singh Grewal (ret'd), who constituted the five-member Special Bench on August 31. Appearing for the creditors before the Special Bench, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta sought to restrain Mr. Chandra from disposing of any property held by him, either directly or indirectly. The Bench acceded to the request.

Meanwhile, dissenting creditors, including LIC Housing Finance and Union Bank of India, have challenged the approval of the repayment plan before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal.

SC seeks Centre’s response on use of ‘totalisers’ in EVM vote counting

The court was hearing a petition arguing ‘totalisers’ would protect voters’ privacy by concealing booth-wise voting patterns; EC says aggregating votes could make individual EVM functioning harder to verify, as it may mask glitches or human error

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought the Centre’s response on the use of “totalisers”, which are machines designed to consolidate and count votes from multiple electronic voting machine (EVM) control units simultaneously without revealing booth-wise voting trends, as a “fall-back option”.

The court’s order to the Centre came despite a warning from the Election Commission (EC) that bringing in totalisers now, when even EVMs are subject to frequent public questioning, may not be the right move.

“It is relevant to state that the present time is one in which the functioning and integrity of EVMs are still a subject of frequent public questioning... In such a climate, the introduction of new and as yet unregulated mechanisms such as totaliser could give rise to fresh allegations and controversy, thereby further complicating public confidence in an already



The poll panel says its main worry is whether totalisers can become fodder for further misapprehension about the EVMs. FILE PHOTO

sensitive area of the electoral process,” the Election Commission (EC) cautioned.

‘No legal framework’

The EC pointed out that there was a complete absence of a legal framework – neither the Representation of the People Act nor the Conduct of Election Rules, 1961, or any allied enactment contain any provision recognising, regulating or governing the use of a totaliser in counting votes. The EC said substantive amendments and revision of statutory procedure governing the count-

ing of votes would have to be made to include totalisers in the electoral process.

“The response from political parties to totalisers is a big ‘no’. Three out of six national parties and 18 out of 29 State parties opposed the idea of totaliser. Only the Law Commission of India, in its 255th report, suggested their selective use,” senior advocate Seshadhri Naidu, for the EC, submitted.

The court was hearing a petition filed by advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, who argued that totalisers would safeguard the privacy of individual voters and

protect them from reprisals. Mr. Upadhyay said political parties victimise voters at the local level after identifying voting patterns in particular polling booths.

A totaliser connects a cluster of 14 control units of EVMs used at 14 polling stations via a cable, which in turn would provide a consolidated result for each candidate in that group of EVMs.

‘May hit transparency’

The EC, in an affidavit, said totalisers would reduce transparency. Currently, polling as well as counting is conducted in the presence of the candidates and their agents.

They are provided an opportunity through Form 17C to match vote count at the end of polling and after counting at every polling station. Form 17C data comparisons are also used at the time of adjudications before election tribunals and courts.

“The one-to-one, booth-wise and EVM-wise correspondence under Form 17C constitute the backbone of the self-verifying and tran-

sparent character of the present counting process. The transparency is necessary to give credence to the outcome of the elections. This knowledge of booth-level voting pattern may be utilised by political parties to improve their outreach programme in the booths where they have not performed up to their expectations, and make corrective organisational decisions,” the EC said.

Totalisers would mask technical malfunction and human error in individual EVMs.

“EVMs clubbed together would stand concealed within the aggregate figure, and would become incapable of being identified, or independently verified by any party to the election... Totaliser, by its very design, aggregates the votes recorded across polling booths at a single point without preserving a distinct booth-wise, machine-wise trail,” the poll body said.

The EC, however, said its main worry was whether totaliser would become fodder for further misapprehension about EVMs.

Bank unions announce strike on September 11

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Seven unions of bank employees, under the United Forum of Bank Unions (UF-BU), have announced an indefinite strike from October 26, raising a four-point charter of demands, including the implementation of five-day banking, a promise made in 2024.

UFBU leaders said on Tuesday that as part of their agitation, all-India bank strikes would be held on September 11, then from September 28-30, and then a “continuous, indefinite” strike would be launched on October 26 if the demands are not met.

In an agreement signed in March 2024, they said, banks had agreed Saturdays would be declared holidays and that working hours would be increased by 40 minutes from Monday to Friday. “...It has been more than two years now, but the issue is still pending with the Finance Ministry,” they said.

They also urged the Centre to withdraw the “unilateral and discriminatory” performance-linked incentive scheme, prescribed by the Union Department of Financial Services (DFS).

Kuki body asks its MLAs to boycott Manipur Assembly

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Kuki Inpi Manipur (KIM), the apex body of the Kuki community, has asked Kuki-Zo MLAs to stay away from the Assembly session beginning Wednesday. The Manipur Assembly session is scheduled to continue until September 7, with three sittings planned.

In a statement on Tuesday, the KIM said the resumption of proceedings should not be treated as a return to normalcy, as the community’s demand for a separate political administration remained unresolved. It said Kuki-Zo MLAs must demonstrate solidarity with the community. It warned those

who ignore the directive would be seen as moving away from the community’s collective position.

“At this critical juncture, the Kuki-Zo MLAs must stand firmly with their people. Political representation cannot be divorced from the political will of the people,” the KIM said.

The organisation maintained there can be no return to “business as usual” without a political settlement for the community that has suffered since the ethnic conflict in Manipur erupted in May 2023.

Ten Kuki-Zo leaders were elected in the 2022 Manipur Assembly polls. One of them, Vungzagin Valte, was attacked by a mob in May 2023 and died in February 2026.

Four Naga villages attacked, pastor shot at, houses torched in Manipur

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Unknown extremists attacked four Liangmai Naga villages along the Imphal-Tamenglong road in Manipur’s Kangpokpi district on Tuesday, less than 24 hours after three Kuki villagers were killed in the vicinity.

The Working Committee of the Tangkhul Naga Long (TNL), the community’s apex body, claimed the Kuki National Front-Presidential (KNF-P) carried out the attacks in collusion with the Kuki National Army (KNA). According to the TNL, the assailants shot at and critically injured Luithuibou Newmai, the pastor of Tapon village, and torched several houses till early afternoon.

“The attacks on four Na-



Women raise slogans during a strike demanding NRC updation before Census 2027, on NH-37 in Imphal on Tuesday. ANI

ga villages were carried out by the KNF-P and KRA cadres led by Jangboi Kipgen, who is also the home secretary of the United People’s Front...,” the TNL said in a statement.

“The modus operandi of the migrant Kukis unleashing repetitive armed offensives within Kangpokpi is intended to effect a demographic change. The landless Kukis are utilising

and employing this pattern of attacks to establish their hegemony over the ancestral land of the Nagas by uprooting us from our homes,” the TNL said.

Noting that these Kuki groups were under the Suspension of Operation (SoO) agreement with the Centre, the TNL criticised the government for its alleged inability to rein in the groups under the deal.

Meanwhile, life was affected across large swathes of Manipur – specifically the five districts of Imphal Valley – on Tuesday after the Campaign for Justice and Fair Delimitation (JFD) enforced a 24-hour general strike despite the Centre having deferred the Census exercise in the State on Monday.

The JFD wants the government to prepare the National Register of Citizens (NRC) in the State before conducting the Census.

The shutdown affected business establishments, public transport, and vehicular movement in several areas, with protesters blocking roads and preventing the movement of vehicles, except those providing essential and emergency services.

Mamata’s niece found dead at home in Birbhum

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

A 31-year-old niece of former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee was found dead at her residence in Birbhum on Tuesday. Police said she was the daughter of one of Ms. Banerjee’s maternal cousins.

The police said the body was found by family members around noon. Rampurhat police inspector Santanu Adhikary said family members stated she had been suffering from severe depression and was also probably stressed due to divorce proceedings.

She lost her job at a high school in March 2023 after the High Court terminated services of employees over alleged irregularities in the School Service Commission exam in 2016.

(Those in distress may avail counselling at Tele MANAS 1800-89-14416.)

Over 7,200 CBI cases under Prevention of Corruption Act pending trial, says CVC report

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Over 7,200 cases probed by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) under the Prevention of Corruption (PC) Act were pending trial as on December 31, 2025. Of these, more than 400 cases were pending for over 20 years, according to the annual report of the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC).

Apart from the 7,229 cases under the Prevention of Corruption (PC) Act awaiting completion of trials, there were 14,083 appeals, revisions, and writ petitions pending under the Act in the High Courts and the Supreme Court. Of them, 3,161 were 10-15 years old, while 1,347 were 15-20 years old, and 739 were over 20 years old.

In 2025, the conviction rate in CBI cases was 71.71%



14,083 appeals, revisions, and writ pleas under the PC Act are pending in HCs and the SC.

against 69.14% for 2024. At the end of the year, 11,510 court cases (including the cases not registered under the PC Act) were pending under trial in various courts.

Last year, the agency had 755 corruption-related cases pending investigation. They included 679 regular cases, 63 preliminary enquiries, and 13 Lokpal references. Of the 679 regular cases, 274 had been pending for over one year. During the year, the

CBI registered 797 regular cases, 177 preliminary enquiries, and recorded 31 Lokpal references.

1,088 vacancies

As of December 31, 2025, sanctioned strength of the CBI was 7,300. However, there were 1,088 vacant positions. The largest vacancy of 672 posts was in the executive ranks. For officers under CVC jurisdiction, 1,460 departmental inquiries were under process during last year, of which 731 were completed. For employees outside its purview, 9,883 departmental inquiries were under process, of which 5,561 were completed.

As many as 34,153 complaints, besides 1,260 carried forward from 2024, were received by the Commission during 2025. It disposed of 35,193 complaints.

Supreme Court to hear Gadling’s bail plea on October 14

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court said on Tuesday it would hear on October 14 a bail plea filed by advocate and activist Surendra Gadling in connection with the 2016 Surjagarh iron ore mine arson case.

Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Mr. Gadling, told a Bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Augustine George Masih, and

Sandeep Mehta that his client had been incarcerated for over seven years. He pointed out Mr. Gadling was also an accused in the Elgar Parishad-Maoist links case and had already been granted bail in that one.

The present plea arises from the 2016 Surjagarh arson case, in which vehicles transporting iron ore in Gadchiroli were allegedly set ablaze by persons associated with the Communist Party of India (Maoist).



APPEAL

Veera Vrindha is 3 years old suffering from “B Cell - Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia”. She needs Bone Marrow Transplantation at Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is **Rs. 16,00,000/-**. Her father work is a electrician on daily wages. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support her for the treatment. Donations sent by Ch/D.D, favouring **Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai**. The donations sent through Ch/D.D/ NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT.

All correspondence is done through **WWS**, Regd Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Cordell Apartments, O.No.13, N.No. 29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 044-42137401/ 31523781/ 7338978027. E-mail ID: womenswelfare syndicate@gmail.com. Website: www.womenswelfare syndicate.org

WWS

Modi lauds 7.8% growth ‘despite war, instability’

PM reiterates appeal to avoid foreign travel, destination weddings and gold purchases, adding that continued emphasis on ‘self-reliance will enable us to hand over a developed India to the youth’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

While congratulating the country on the 7.8% economic growth witnessed in the April-June 2026 quarter, Prime Minister Narendra Modi once again cautioned the Indian public to choose ‘Swadeshi’ in terms of their travel plans and wedding locations, and to refrain from buying gold unless necessary.

The government on Monday released the latest data on India’s Gross Domestic Product (GDP), which showed that GDP grew 7.8% in the April-June 2026 quarter as compared to 6.9% in the same quarter last year. This, Mr. Modi said, was a remarkable achievement given the global situation.

‘Fast progress’
“The world is drowned in war,” he said in a social media post. “There is news of war all around. The world is surrounded by crises. The supply chain is completely disturbed. From



the COVID era in 2020 till today, stability is not visible anywhere. Despite that, India is progressing at a fast pace.”

Reiterates appeal
However, he also reiterated the appeal he made in May in which he had asked Indians to avoid activities that would result in crucial foreign exchange flowing out of the country. “Don’t travel to foreign countries for tourism,” Mr. Modi said in his latest video. “Avoid organising destination weddings in foreign countries. We should live by the mantra of ‘Wed in India’. Avoid buying gold if it’s not necessary.”

“If we continue to em-

phasise self-reliance, I have full faith that when we reach 100 years of independence, we will hand over a developed India to our youth,” he added.

The Prime Minister had made a similar appeal in May, at the height of the ongoing West Asia conflict.

At the time, he had asked Indians to prioritise working from home, reduce petrol and diesel usage by using public transport and electric vehicles, reduce the use of cooking oil, stop buying gold for at least a year, buy Indian-made products rather than foreign ones, pause foreign travel, and adopt natural fertilizers instead of using imported chemical ones.

Rahul should apologise for remarks on economy: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The BJP demanded an apology from Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday for his criticism of the state of the Indian economy. Addressing a press conference, BJP MP Ravi Shankar Prasad credited Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s leadership and the government’s economic policies for the 7.8% GDP growth, while also lauding the contribution of Indian industry, businesses, and workers.

Mr. Prasad said the latest figures had “exposed” what he described as the “false and baseless” narrative being pushed by the Congress. He said Mr. Gandhi should apologise for his “dead economy” remark.

Congress accuses Centre of ‘statistical gymnastics’ over GDP growth figures

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Tuesday questioned the Narendra Modi government’s celebration of 7.8% GDP growth in the first quarter of 2026-27, with party president Mallikarjun Kharge dismissing the Prime Minister’s video on the issue as a “PR exercise”. In a separate post on X, Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh took a dig at the government, saying that while the Make in India initiative had achieved little, its “Fake in India” scheme continued unabated.

Mr. Kharge said the Prime Minister may have the “luxury” of celebrating the growth figures, but ordinary citizens continue to grapple with what he described as the three “U”s – “unprecedented unemployment, unbearable price rise and unbridled inequality”.

“Lights. Camera and IN-ACTION. This is the story of Modi’s PR when it comes to the economy,” Mr. Kharge said in a post on X, responding to a video posted by Mr. Modi



Mallikarjun Kharge

hailing the 7.8% GDP growth in the April-June quarter.

The Congress president alleged that unemployment and rising prices had placed an increasing burden on households. He claimed that the promise of creating 2 crore jobs annually had remained unfulfilled and pointed to unemployment among young people as well as the rising cost of essential commodities and fuel.

Mr. Kharge also accused the government of presiding over growing inequality and alleged that its economic policies had facilitated a transfer of wealth from poorer sections to the rich.

Mr. Ramesh questioned the methodology behind the latest GDP figures, de-

scribing them as “statistical gymnastics” that, he alleged, concealed the underlying weakness of the economy.

“The gap between nominal and real GDP is supposed to represent inflation. According to the government, the difference is just 2.3%. But this quarter has seen runaway Wholesale Price Index inflation of over 9%. This is an obvious discrepancy,” he said.

Mr. Ramesh alleged that the discrepancy had arisen because the government had changed the methodology for calculating GDP twice this year, including moving away from the Wholesale Price Index for the latest estimates.

In a separate post, Mr. Ramesh accused the government of subjecting people to a “high-voltage shock” of rising prices while attempting to mask the situation through “statistical juggling”.

He said inflation was no longer confined to kitchen staples and had begun affecting the cost of building homes and purchasing electrical and electronic goods.

Nadda hails CJP’s decision to call off Sept. 5 protest

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda on Tuesday welcomed the Cockroach Janata Party’s (CJP) decision to call off the protest it had planned on September 5.

The Minister’s statement came after CJP co-convenor Saurav Das informed the Supreme Court that it had decided to withdraw the call for a march in view of the positive assurances of the government.

The court quashed all first information reports (FIRs) registered against the students who participated in the protests between July 20 and 25.

“Keeping the students’ future in mind, we, on behalf of the Government of India, gave an assurance that the cases registered against the protesting students would be withdrawn, and that no harsh action would be taken against them in the future,” Mr. Nadda said.

“We also consulted with the governments in BJP-ruled States. Proceedings are under way to fulfil that assurance,” Mr. Nadda said, adding that the welfare of the youth was the government’s top priority.

BJP chief discusses bilateral ties with Russian envoy

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) president Nitin Nabin on Tuesday met Russian Ambassador to India Denis Alipov at the party headquarters, a day after Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Russian President Vladimir Putin on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit.

“The interaction focused on the long-standing and time-tested India-Russia relationship. Mr. Nabin highlighted the strong personal understanding and trust between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Vladimir Putin, noting that their regular high-level interactions have provided sustained momentum to bilateral relations,” the BJP said in a statement.

Mr. Nabin also appreciated Mr. Alipov’s long association with India and his contribution to strengthening ties between the two countries.

“The recent meeting between Prime Minister Modi and President Putin on the sidelines of the SCO Summit was also discussed. Mr. Nabin ex-



BJP chief Nitin Nabin with Ambassador Denis Alipov in New Delhi on Tuesday.

pressed optimism about the continued strengthening of India-Russia relations and looked forward to further high-level engagements, including in the context of the upcoming BRICS Summit in India,” the statement said.

“Both sides emphasised the importance of people-to-people ties as an enduring pillar of India-Russia relations. Ambassador Alipov highlighted the growing potential for skilled Indian professionals to contribute in Russia. Mr. Nabin also shared an overview of the BJP’s organisational journey...,” said the party.

“Both sides looked forward to 80 years of India-Russia diplomatic relations in 2027 as an important milestone,” the BJP said.

Congress attacks BJP over exclusion of over 2 crore voters in Maharashtra SIR

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Flagging the exclusion of over two crore names in Maharashtra’s draft electoral rolls after the special intensive revision (SIR), the Congress on Tuesday said votes were being added and deleted to ensure that the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) wins elections.

The deletions in Maharashtra, where draft rolls were published on Monday, are the largest in absolute numbers for any State in the ongoing Phase 3 of the SIR.

Following the 2024 Maharashtra elections, the Congress had formally submitted representations to the Election Commission alleging large-scale voter roll manipulation, including unusual voter spikes in several constituencies. It had alleged that forged documentation, such as fake Aadhaar cards with mismatched names and photos, were used to add fictitious voters without physical verification of addresses.

On Tuesday, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said “the BJP and the ‘vote theft



Youth Congress workers stage a protest in Nagpur on August 12 over alleged irregularities in the SIR process. ANI

commission’ keep changing their tactics, and they will continue to do so; the goal remains just one: BJP’s victory at any cost, and the end of India’s democracy”.

In a post on X, he said: “Maharashtra 2024 - Suddenly, 3.9 million new voters were added between the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. I said it then, and I say it today: This was vote theft.”

“And now in Maharashtra, 2.07 crore voters have been removed from the draft list – that’s every fifth voter. Lok Sabha 2024: 9.29 crore, Vidhan Sabha 2024: 9.7 crore, SIR 2026: 7.78 crore. Which list was correct,” Mr. Gandhi asked.

“For a government built on vote theft, the people

are not important—that’s why this BJP neither listens to the people nor obeys their command,” he added.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said votes are added when it suits the BJP. “Where it doesn’t, votes are split to perpetrate vote theft,” he said.

“The BJP’s conspiracy to hollow out Indian democracy by stealing votes is coming out into the open. Instead of acting as the guardian of fair elections, the Election Commission is functioning like the “Save BJP’s Chair Commission,” he wrote on X.

Both leaders said that in West Bengal, 91% of the voter names struck off in the SIR had to be reinstated after appeals.

People need jobs and democracy, not propaganda: Raja

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Communist Party of India (CPI) on Tuesday accused the Centre of pursuing pro-corporate policies and sought to intensify its political agitation against the Narendra Modi government.

The party held a public meeting at Delhi’s Ramlila Maidan at the conclusion of its nationwide *padayatra*, organised from August 6 to 15 against the government, under the slogan “*Badlaav zaroori hai*” (change is essential).

Addressing the rally, CPI general secretary D. Raja accused the BJP-led government at the Centre of running a “fascist regime”. “Poor people across the country are being deprived of their fundamental rights. The government is corporatising public sector undertakings. The education system has been demolished,” Mr. Raja said.

He said the government’s policies, including the dilution of the rural employment guarantee programme and the commercialisation of education and healthcare, were aimed at benefiting a few “crony capitalists”. “Peo-



D. Raja. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

ple need jobs, MSP, social security, dignity, justice and democracy, not propaganda, hatred and division,” Mr. Raja said.

Drawing a parallel with the Indian Freedom Struggle against British rule, Mr. Raja said the country must come together to “defeat the RSS-BJP Raj of division, inequality and authoritarianism”.

CPI national secretary Amarjeet Kaur said the BJP and the RSS had always singled out Left parties as their primary political opponents. “Should we forget the fact that Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in a meeting of the BJP’s top leadership three years ago, termed the communists dangerous and said that the communists must be finished? Today, we have come to tell you that we will finish you,” she said.

Dipke hails quashing of FIRs against students

Press Trust of India
CHHATRAPATI SAMBAHAJINAGAR

Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Tuesday welcomed the Supreme Court’s move to quash all FIRs registered against students who participated in the protests across the country following NEET-UG paper leaks, calling it “absolute justice”.

Mr. Dipke thanked the court and said justice had been dispensed to all those who fought at Jantar Mantar and to the families of those who died due to NEET paper leak.

“Our demands have been met. This is absolute justice. It took us a month [for this],” Mr. Dipke said.

He said this was made possible due to people’s power, adding that he had been holding meetings with several delegations on the issue.

“I apologise to the families that we could not save your kids. We are very sorry that you lost your kids,” the CJP convenor said.

“The government has accepted the demands, but it has to take responsibility that not a single student dies due to paper leak,” he said.

Statistical Institute Bill referred to standing committee by Speaker

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

A Bill seeking to widen the remit of the Indian Statistical Institute and align its legal framework with evolving needs was referred to a parliamentary committee on Tuesday.

The Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026, was referred to the Department-Related Standing Committee on Finance by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

The committee has been asked to submit its report “within three months”, a Lok Sabha bulletin said.

Amid protests by its faculty, the Opposition had demanded that the Bill be referred to a standing committee.

The Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha on August 2 during the Monsoon Session. It seeks the institute’s incorporation as a “body corporate” to strengthen its governance.

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & an ISO 27001:2022 Certified Company)
VIDYUTH SOUDHA, VIJAYAWADA-520004.

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for **Spec No. PMWTC3-e-41/2026**,
Work: “Procurement of infrastructure for establishment of enterprise Wi-Fi Network at APTRANSCO Headquarters, Vidut Soudha, Gunadala, Vijayawada”,
Date & Time of availability of Tender: **02.09.2026 at 18:00 PM**, Web: <http://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in>
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/124/26-27 **Sd/- Chief Engineer/Telecom & IT**

idco **ODISHA**
Your power to grow NEW OPPORTUNITIES
ISO 9001 & 14001 Corporation

**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL),
IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR**

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/25/2026-27 : TCN No.24781, dt.20/08/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Block level Stadium (with Indoor Hall) in Rairakhol Block under Sambalpur District.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.877.00 Lakhs

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :

i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt.10.09.2026

ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt.24.09.2026

iii. Opening date : 11:30 Hours of dt.25.09.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/287/2627. OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0099

THE HIGH COURT OF ORISSA : CUTTACK

Tender Notice

Bid Reference No. XXIX-14/ 2026/ CGHIS / Dated 01.09.2026

The High Court of Orissa invites tender in sealed covers from interested Insurance Companies for providing Cashless Group Health Insurance Policy for In-service Judicial Officers, Retired Judicial Officers / Pensioners, Family Pensioners and Members of their Family.

1. Last date for submission of Bid - 28.09.2026 on or before 05:00 PM.

2. Opening of Technical Bids - 01.10.2026 at 11:30 AM.

For detailed terms and conditions of the tender Notice, interested bidders may visit the High Court of Orissa website : <https://www.orissahighcourt.nic.in/tender-notice/>.

**Sd/-
Registrar (Judicial) ,
High Court of Orissa, Cuttack**

18001/76/2627 OIPR-18001/18002/1/26-27/0001

Three members of a family were killed in a landslide and a woman was killed in a rockfall in Guwahati early on Tuesday, following incessant rain. Kamrup Metropolitan District Disaster Management Authority officials said a couple and their minor daughter died in a landslide in the Mathgharia area, while 65-year-old P. Sumitra was killed when a rock fell on her house in the Satgaon area. Three persons were injured in the rockfall. Those killed in Mathgharia were identified as Nagen Rajbongshi, 44, his wife Sanu Rajbongshi, 38, and their 12-year-old daughter, Meena Rajbongshi. Their 19-year-old son, Biplab Rajbongshi, was rescued.

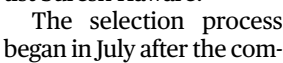
A Delhi-bound IndiGo flight with 229 passengers on board returned to Goa about 30 minutes after take-off on Tuesday and made an emergency landing at Manohar International Airport after one engine failed mid-air, sources said. The aircraft landed safely at the airport in Mopa, North Goa. "IndiGo flight 6E 2102, which departed for Delhi at 9.16 a.m., returned to Goa after reporting a failure in one of its engines. The Air Traffic Control declared a full emergency around 9.30 a.m., and the aircraft landed safely on runway 28 at 9.51 a.m.," a source said. Arrangements were made for the passengers to reach their destination, the airline said. PTI

The Nagaland Assembly on Tuesday introduced the revised Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority (FNTA) Bill, 2026, proposing a regional authority with legislative, administrative and financial powers over six eastern districts. The proposed Frontier Nagaland Territory will comprise Tuensang, Mon, Longleng, Kiphire, Noklak and Shamator districts. The Bill is based on the memorandum of agreement between the Centre, the Nagaland government and the Eastern Nagaland Peoples' Organisation (ENPO) on February 5, seeking to provide for decentralised self-governance under Article 371A, which provides Nagaland special provisions. PTI

The Delhi High Court has sought a response from the Centre and the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on a petition by AWL Agri Business Ltd. challenging action by the FSSAI prohibiting the manufacture and sale of its “Fortune Soya Health Refined Soyabean Oil” over alleged misleading label declarations and claims. The company has challenged FSSAI’s action on two claims made on the packaging of the product: “100% Veg” and “cholesterol Free - For Healthy Lifestyle”. The court issued a notice to the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, FSSAI, and other authorities and directed them to file their responses within four weeks.

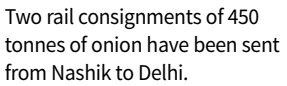
The lawyer alleged that the police efforts were to unearth his client's sources and to harass them.

"The trust was also considering changes to its by-



The names of the short-listed candidates have not been disclosed, but sources said the panel includes candidates from government and private sectors.

The government said in a release that two "Kanda (onion) Express" consignments of 450 tonnes had been dispatched from Nashik to Delhi and of these, 140 tonnes was distributed across Varanasi, Lucknow, Chandigarh and

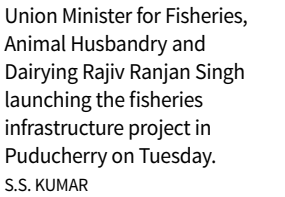


Amritsar. The second rake, carrying 840 tonnes of onions, reached Chennai on Tuesday.

On sugar, the government added that under the amended stocking provisions, a sugar dealer should not hold any stock for a period exceeding 30 days from the date of receipt of such stock.

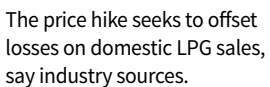
“Do not keep sugar in stock, at any time and in any place throughout the country, in excess of 2,000 quintals. However,... the stock holding limit shall remain at 4,000 quintals for Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas,” the release said.

Mr. Singh was here to launch fisheries infrastructure projects, including an upgrade of Thengaithittu Fishing Harbour, establishment of state-of-the-art



Fish Landing Centre at Nallavadu and Advanced Centre for Innovation and Capacity Development for seaweed farming in Karikal. He said the infrastructure projects taken up under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana would become a major asset in strengthening the fishing community. They would promote systematic auction, reduce post-harvest losses, encourage women-led seaweed enterprises and generate local employment, he said.

The price of the free-trade five-kg cylinders, which cater largely to the migrant populations, was also increased by approximately ₹2 a cylinder.



crease of ₹10.5. A five-kg free-trade LPG cylinder will now cost ₹764 in the national capital. The sales of free-trade LPG cylinders have recently seen an uptick, with new LPG connections on hold amid supply uncertainties due to the re-escalation of the conflict in West Asia.

According to Prashant Vashisht, senior vice-president and co-group head, corporate sector ratings, at ratings agency ICRA, the latest commercial LPG price hike primarily seeks to somewhat offset the under-recoveries being incurred on domestic LPG cylinders.

Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday reviewed the annual performance of all 16 defence Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs).

In a meeting, the Minister called upon the defence PSUs to reduce import dependence, strengthen research and development, ensure timely delivery of major projects, and transform themselves into globally competitive defence companies, the Defence Ministry said in a statement. Mr. Singh was briefed by Secretary (Defence Production) Sanjeev Kumar, and the Chairmen and MDs of the defence PSUs on their performance, achievements, and road maps. Mr. Singh reviewed the progress made by state-owned defence companies in improving indigenous manufacturing capabilities, defence technologies, exports, and supply chains, and executing major projects.

Solution to previous puzzle

R	I	F	R	E	D	I	N	S	L	I	P
O	K	R	A	S	B	Y	N	O	M	E	A
C	E	T	I	E	M	P	E	N	P	Y	
K	A	S	H	M	I	R	S	P	A	S	T
S	E	T	A	D	I	R	E	H			
S	H	R	E	N	B	A	B	C	I	N	O
C	O	M	E	T	R	E	N	E			
I	R	R	O	R	D	E					
E	X	P	L	A	I	N	G	R	I	E	V
N	E	I	P	R	N	E	A				
C	U	T	S	T	O	C	E	O	W	N	U
E	A	E	K	S	C	C					
E	B	L	A	D	E	R	S	T	O	N	E

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

1	3	2	6	4	9	5	7	8
7	6	9	8	2	5	3	1	4
4	5	8	7	3	1	9	2	6
6	9	5	4	1	7	8	3	2
3	8	1	2	9	6	7	4	5
2	7	4	3	5	8	1	6	9
8	2	6	5	7	3	4	9	1
9	4	3	1	8	2	6	5	7
5	1	7	9	6	4	2	8	3

Vidura was an incarnation of Yama Dharma Raja (the God of Justice), who was cursed by sage Mandavya to be born on earth. Vidura grew up with unmatched wisdom, righteousness and humility. His devotion to truth, dharma, and Lord Krishna was unmatched. Vidura is known as Vidura Azhwar because his pure devotion (bhakti) earned him a place among the highly revered Azhwaras, said Tirukundanthai Dr. Venkatesh in a discourse. Dharmaputra says Vidura raised and protected the five Pandavas like a bird, with dharma on one wing and wisdom on the other. He fearlessly spoke the truth to King Dhritirashtra and Duryodhana, warning them against injustice and wrongdoing committed against the Pandavas that would lead to the destruction of the Kaurava lineage. When Duryodhana and Dushasana humiliated Draupadi in the royal court, great elders such as Bhishma and Dronacharya did not intervene to stop the injustice. Vidura was one of the most prominent voices who courageously spoke against what was happening. An important portion of the Mahabharata is Vidura Neethi, the wise counsel and advice given by Vidura to Dhritirashtra. It can be described as a precious gem of the Mahabharata, containing profound teachings on dharma, righteousness, conduct, wisdom, and the right way of living.

Lord Krishna travels to Hastinapur as the Pandavas' peace envoy to prevent the great war between the Pandavas and the Kauravas. He firmly declines Duryodhana's, Bhishma's and Drona's hospitality and walks directly to Vidura's simple house because Vidura's heart is pure, free of greed, and filled with devotion.

Business

INBRIEF



Inara Foods, Kalimark tie up to expand snack distribution

Inara Foods, an SPV of Whiteleaf Ventures Pvt. Ltd. and Dubai-based Plus Investments LLC of the Al Ghurair Group, has announced a distribution partnership with the Kalimark Group, expanding the reach of former's portfolio of snack products, including chikkis, flavoured peanuts, chips, mixtures and other offerings, to nearly one lakh retail outlets across Tamil Nadu through Kalimark's extensive distribution network. Nawabzada Mohammed Asif Ali, Chairman of Whiteleaf Ventures, said the company aims to establish Inara Foods as a leading snack brand across Tamil Nadu, with plans to expand its presence across India in the future.

IRDAI kick starts consultation for Public Insurance Registry

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) released a consultation paper for the Public Insurance Registry on Tuesday describing the PIR it is proposing as a population-scale, interoperable and non-exclusionary digital public infrastructure (DPI). The objectives of the PIR are to facilitate growth and inclusion, building trust and transparency, and promoting affordability and financial sustainability. It is significant step towards building a more connected, transparent, efficient and resilient insurance ecosystem, with trusted information serving as a foundation for better protection, innovation and public value, the regulator said. The proposal, is in line with the objectives of the Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha Act, 2025, draws inspiration from the success and lessons from DPis in other sectors of Indian economy. It is intended to enable technology, governance and market participation to work together towards wider and deeper financial resilience.

PV wholesales surge in Aug. as Maruti, Tata, M&M drive double-digit growth

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

India's passenger vehicle (PV) market maintained a strong growth trajectory in August with major auto-makers reporting robust year-on-year (YoY) gains amid sustained local demand. Wholesales were estimated at about 4.5 lakh units for the month, said senior industry officials.

Market leader Maruti Suzuki India Ltd. led the market with total wholesales of 2,19,220 units, up 21.3%. Domestic wholesales jumped 34.3%, offsetting a 7% dip in exports to 33,844 units as shipments were affected by the West Asia conflict. Sales to other OEMs fell 48% to 5,298.



Maruti Suzuki cars are seen parked inside the company factory at Manesar.

Maruti said it crossed the one-million-unit mark in the first five months of FY27 on higher output and strong demand.

"We have a booking backlog of 1.8 lakh vehicles. Our SUV share in our entire portfolio has risen to 36% from 12% five years

GST revenue grows 14.8% in Aug. to nearly ₹2 lakh crore

Official data show revenue from imports grew 29%, whereas revenue from domestic transactions grew in the single digits; net collections grew a relatively lower 8.3% on higher refunds given out

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections grew nearly 15% to about ₹2 lakh crore in August, official data released on Tuesday showed. Net collections, however, grew a relatively lower 8.3% on higher refunds being given out.

The Gross GST revenue stood at ₹1,99,853 crore in August 2026, reflecting the business activity of July.

The data also shows that the collections for August last year were revised downward from the originally reported ₹1.86 lakh crore to ₹1.74 lakh crore. As a result, the growth in gross collections in July 2026 now stands at 14.8%.

Had the July 2025 figure not been revised, growth



The sharp 72.6% surge in domestic refunds driven by inverted duty structures signals an imbalance, says an analyst. GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCK

in gross GST collections in August 2026 would have been 7%.

Within the data, tax analysts have also pointed out the continued robust growth in revenues from imports as opposed to the slower growth in revenue from domestic transactions.

"The quality of collections warrants closer attention," Manoj Mishra, Partner and Tax Controversy Management Leader at Grant Thornton Bharat said. "While gross GST revenue expanded by 14.8% year-on-year, domestic collections grew 9.3%, whereas import-related GST

surged 29%, indicating that trade-linked activity continues to make a disproportionately higher contribution to revenue buoyancy."

They also pointed out that the sharp increase in refunds, which grew nearly 68% overall in August 2026, also pointed to structural issues that the GST Council should take note of in its next meeting scheduled on September 12.

"The sharp 72.6% surge in domestic refunds, driven by inverted duty structures, signals a structural imbalance that warrants urgent redressal," Vivek Jalan, Partner at Tax Connect Advisory Services LLP said. "The Hon'ble GST Council may address these anomalies in its forthcoming meeting to ensure that the tax framework supports competitiveness."

India's current account deficit widens to \$4.2 bn in Q1 FY27

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

India's current account deficit (CAD) widened to \$4.2 billion, or 0.5% of GDP, in the first quarter of 2026-27, compared with \$3.4 billion, or 0.4% of GDP, in the year-ago period, according to preliminary data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday.

The widening deficit

was primarily driven by a higher merchandise trade gap, which increased to \$86.1 billion in Q1 FY27 from \$68.9 billion in the corresponding quarter of 2025-26.

However, stronger services earnings and higher remittance receipts provided some cushion. Net services receipts rose to \$51.6 billion during the quarter from \$47.9 billion a year earlier. Services exports re-

However, stronger services earnings and higher remittance receipts provided some cushion

corded year-on-year growth across major segments, including computer services, other business services and transportation services.

The net outflow under the primary income account

declined to \$10.5 billion in Q1 FY27 from \$13.3 billion in the year-ago quarter, mainly reflecting lower investment income payments, the RBI said.

Personal transfer receipts under the secondary income account, largely comprising remittances from Indians employed overseas, increased sharply to \$42.9 billion from \$33.2 billion a year earlier.

On the financial ac-

count, net foreign direct investment (FDI) inflows rose to \$6.1 billion in Q1 FY27 from \$5.2 billion in Q1 FY26.

Foreign portfolio investment (FPI), however, recorded a net outflow of \$9.6 billion during the quarter, reversing a net inflow of \$1.6 billion in the corresponding period last year. Net inflows into non-resident deposits stood at \$2.8 billion, lower than the

\$3.6 billion recorded in Q1 FY26. Net inflows under external commercial borrowings (ECBs) also moderated to \$3.3 billion from \$4.4 billion a year earlier.

India's foreign exchange reserves declined by \$8.1 billion on a balance-of-payments basis during Q1 FY27, compared with an accretion of \$4.5 billion in the same quarter of the previous year, according to the RBI.

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

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Maruti Suzuki cars are seen parked inside the company factory at Manesar.

Maruti said it crossed the one-million-unit mark in the first five months of FY27 on higher output and strong demand.

"We have a booking backlog of 1.8 lakh vehicles. Our SUV share in our entire portfolio has risen to 36% from 12% five years

ago," said Partho Banerjee, senior executive officer, sales and marketing, Maruti Suzuki India.

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd. posted a 56% rise in total wholesales to 67,753 units.

Mahindra & Mahindra reported overall auto sales of 1,07,648 units, including exports, a 42% increase.

"Demand continues to be strong across our portfolio, with the updated Scorpio-N and BE 6 SPORTEQ receiving strong market response from customers," said Velusamy R., president, automotive business, M&M.

Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) wholesales of 65,796 units showed an 8.8% growth. Domestic

sales rose 23.6% to 54,396 while exports slid to 11,400 from more than 16,000 a year earlier on West Asia issue.

"We are optimistic that export demand will continue to be strong in the coming months as the geopolitical situation improves," said Tarun Garg, MD & CEO, HMIL.

Kia India recorded one of the strongest growth rates among major PV makers with dispatches rising 48% to 29,042 units.

JSW MG Motor India also sustained growth momentum with a 14% rise in sales to 7,508 units. It said demand was strong across both internal combustion engine and new energy vehicle (NEV) portfolios.

'FII tax cuts same as Centre funding their under-performance'

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Dwindling stock market returns in Indian indices, especially for foreign institutional investors (FIIs) should not determine tax policy changes, said Harendra Kumar, MD-CEO, Elara Capital

Speaking to *The Hindu*, he said pushing for tax cuts for FIIs is "asking the government to fund their under-performance".

"The FII amount is over the cost and rupee depreciation. They should make money post-tax. This problem was not there two years ago as they were



Harendra Kumar

making serious money," he said, asking why they had not raised the issue two years ago when they were making money. He added it was not even international investors but hedge funds and high frequency traders complaining about taxation in India.

'CIE scheme to boost local making, cut import dependence'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Construction and Infrastructure Equipment (CIE) scheme announced in Union Budget 2026-27 will boost local manufacturing, boost local supply chain and cut excessive dependence on imports, Union Heavy Industries Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy said at an event here.

The scheme's modalities are yet to be finalised. While Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in her Budget speech on February 1 announced a scheme at an estimated ₹200 crore, media reports

suggest the Centre is considering a much broader programme with an incentive outlay of ₹11,500 crore over seven years.

The need to encourage greater participation of micro, small and medium enterprises in the construction equipment value chain was also underlined by the Minister.

India is the world's third-largest construction equipment market after China and the U.S. The industry, valued at about ₹97,500 crore in 2024-25, provides direct employment to about 10 lakh and is likely to touch ₹2.28 lakh crore by 2029-30.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
VIGILANCE & SECURITY DEPARTMENT
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender invited for the work of Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of CCTV Cameras, erection of poles and associated accessories for the newly constructed TTD Paediatric Super Specialty Hospital, Tirupati, including Three (03) years of Comprehensive On-site Warranty and Five (05) years of Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC). The tender document will be available for download from **02.09.2026 at 11.00 AM**. The last date and time for submission of bids is **28.09.2026 at 05.00 PM**. The pre-bid meeting will be held on **10.09.2026 at 11.00 AM**. For further details, please visit www.tirumala.org or tender.appeprocurement.gov.in to view and download the Tender Document. For further enquiries, please contact Phone No. **0877-2264279** between **10:30 AM and 05:00 PM** on working days.
TID-40021(31)/1/2026-PRD SEC(Adv.No.169) Date:01-09-2026
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
O/o The Deputy Chief Engineer, Transmission Circle, Vidyuthi Bhavanam, Kannur.
E-Tender ID No. **2026_KSEB_866782**, PAC: Rs. **4,65,85,844/-**,
Last Date: **15.09.2026, 02.00 pm**,
O/o The Deputy Chief Engineer, Electrical Circle, Pathanamthitta.
E-Tender ID No. **2026_KSEB_865942**, 1. PAC: Rs. **3,63,15,060/-**,
Last Date: **18.09.2026, 05.00 pm**,
O/o The Deputy Chief Engineer, Civil Circle, Kothamangalam, Ernakulam.
E-Tender ID No. **2026_KSEB_866437**, PAC: Rs. **5,50,34,441/-**,
Last Date: **29.09.2026, 03.00 pm**.
Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in and www.kseb.in Ref: PR/MC/1/E631-E-tender/2026

TRAVANCORE DEVASWOM BOARD
Devaswom Commissioner Office
Nanthancode, Thiruvananthapuram - 695 003
E-mail: dcotdbs@gmail.com Ph: 9188911421
ROC No: 26/2026/SAB 01-09-2026
CORRIGENDUM NOTICE
Tender for the Supply of Powdered Jaggery
It is hereby notified that the dates prescribed in the tender notification for the supply of Powdered Jaggery have been revised. Accordingly, the revised schedule for submission and opening of the tender is as follows:
Particulars | Revised Date
Last date and time for submission of tender : **14/09/2026, 10.00 AM**
Date of opening of tender : **15/09/2026, 10.00 AM**
All other terms and conditions stipulated in the original tender notification shall remain unchanged. Tenderers are requested to take note of the above changes and submit their tenders accordingly.
Sd/-, Devaswom Commissioner

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, खण्ड नोखा
क्रमांक- 1492 दिनांक- 24.08.2026
Short Term Notice Inviting Bid - 08 /2026-27
Bids for Renewal of Roads Under S & R Programme are invited from interested bidders upto **24.08.2026 [09:30 AM]** to **02.09.2026 [06:00PM]**, other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://www.pwd.rajasthan.gov.in> & eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & sppp.rajasthan.gov.in of the state and departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is **Rs. 379.35 Lakh**.
NIB CODE No: **PWD2627A2546**
UBN :- **PWD2627WS0811436, PWD2627WS0811437**
DIPR/C/15463/2026
Executive Engineer
PWD Dn. Nokha

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, WATERSHED DEVELOPMENT & SOIL CONSERVATION, ZILA PARISHAD SAWAI MADHOPUR
File no. /J/1401 Date: 25.08.2026
NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No. 15 YEAR 2026-27
(6 Packages) Bids for Seed Bin, Spray Machine & Manger (Pashu Than) etc. production activity under PMKSY 2.0 in Sawai Madhopur district of estimated value INR 177.79 LACs (49.11+18.77+44.24+36.51+10.20+18.96) are invited from interested bidders up to 6:00 PM DATE 01.09.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> or <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>) of the state and department website (<https://water.rajasthan.gov.in/wdsc>).
NIB code **WSC2627A1095**
UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01989**, UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01990**, UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01991**, UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01992**, UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01993**, UBN is: **WSC2627GLOB01994**
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER WATERSHED DEVELOPMENT & SOIL CONSERVATION ZILA PARISHAD SAWAI MADHOPUR
DIPR/C/15497/2026

RAIL WHEEL FACTORY
YELAHANKA, BENGALURU-560064. Website: www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in
PENSION ADALAT-2026
Pension Adalat for Pensioners and Family pensioners of Rail Wheel Factory will be held at **11:00 hrs. on 15.12.2026 (Tuesday)**, at Conference Hall, Administration Building, Rail Wheel Factory to redress the grievances of Pensioners/Family Pensioners Pertaining to "PENSIONARY BENEFITS" only.
Pensioners/Family Pensioners may send their grievances with full details addressed to Assistant Personnel Officer, Rail Wheel Factory, Yelahanka, Bangalore-560064 to reach on or before **15.11.2026** in an envelope duly superscribed as "PENSION ADALAT"-2026 or they can also e-mail their grievances to ks.poornima@gov.in
Cases involving purely legal or policy matters will not be entertained in the Pension Adalat.
PRINCIPAL CHIEF PERSONNEL OFFICER

RATAN TATA INNOVATION HUB
4th Floor, Mayuri Tech Park, NH 16, Mangalagiri, AP **RTIH**
Notification for Recruitment on Contract basis
Ratan Tata Innovation Hub (RTIH), Dept. of ITE&C, Govt. of Andhra Pradesh invites online applications from eligible candidates for the following **17 posts** on **contract basis**, initially for a period of **one (1) year**, extendable based on performance and organizational requirements.
Name of Posts & No. of Posts (Location-wise): **Amaravati** – Head-Incubation (01), Head-Partnerships (01), Manager-Incubation (01), Manager Incubation AI & Deep Tech Ecosystems (01), Technical Lead AI Platforms & HPC Infrastructure (01), Finance Executive (01); **Vijayawada** – Chief Executive Officer (01), Head-Incubation (01), Head-Partnerships (01), Head-Finance (01); **Anantapur** – Head-Partnerships (01), Head-Finance (01); **Rajahmundry** – Manager-Partnerships (01), Manager-Finance (01); **Tirupati** – Head-Partnerships (01), Head-Finance (01), Manager-Startup & Ecosystem Development (01). **Total No. of Posts: 17.**
For detailed notification, eligibility criteria and to apply, visit website – <https://rtih.co.in/careers>. Last Date for Submission of Online Application: 12-09-2026. Selection Process: Shortlisted candidates will be called for a written test and personal interview. No TA/DA shall be paid. **For clarifications, email – connect@rtih.co.in**
DIPR 5384PP/CL, Dt.01-09-2026 **Sd/- Group Chief Executive Officer, RTIH**

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
(Mahadevapura Zone) Bengaluru East City Corporation,
Vengaihanala Lake ECO Park, KR Pura, Bengaluru-560036.
No:SADH(MDP/KRP)TENDER/198/2026-27 Date: 01-09-2026
LETTER OF INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT) (TWO COVER SYSTEM)
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura/KR Pura), BECC (Referred to as Employer in these documents) invites tenders to Implement in accordance with KTPP rules 2000, from eligible and experienced Person/Agencies/Firms (Referred to as Tenderers in these documents) registered in Labour Departments for development of Parks. (Standard tender documents KW-3)

Sl No.	Name of the work
1.	Beautification, landscape development, water facility and other civil works including borewells digging in Sadaramangala Lake in Ward No.29 (Call-2). Amount put to tender: ₹. 1,50,00,000 EMD Amount: ₹. 2,25,000/-

Calendar of Events : (1) Date of Notification on **02-09-2026** (2) Tender can be downloaded from **02-09-2026** (3) Last Date for Queries on **05-09-2026** (4) Pre bid Meeting on **05-09-2026** (5) Tender Closing Date **09-09-2026** (6) Technical bid opening date **11-09-2026** (7) Financial bid opening date: After Approval Technical Bid.
Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura/KR Pura Zone), BECC

INBRIEF



Barcelona confirms Jesus arrival from Arsenal

Barcelona signed Brazilian forward Gabriel Jesus from Arsenal on Tuesday on a deal until 2029, after it was unable to pry Julian Alvarez from Atletico Madrid. “Barcelona and Arsenal have reached a deal for the Brazilian striker Gabriel Jesus,” said the Catalan club in a statement, with Spanish media reporting that Barca paid the Gunners around €10 million. Jesus arrives to bolster an attack weakened by the departures of Robert Lewandowski and Ferran Torres earlier this summer.

Unnati loses in first round of China Masters badminton

Unnati Hooda fell at the first hurdle in women’s singles, while men’s doubles pair Hariharan Amsakarunan and M.R. Arjun retired at the first-game interval of their opening-round match at the China Masters Super 750 badminton tournament in Shenzhen on Tuesday.

The results (first round): Women: Kim Ga Eun bt Unnati Hooda 21-10, 21-18; **Men: Doubles:** Chen Bo Yang & Liu Yi bt Hariharan Amsakarunan & M.R. Arjun 8-11 (ret.).



Villa signs Senegalese winger Mbaye from PSG

Aston Villa signed Senegal winger Ibrahim Mbaye from Paris Saint-Germain (PSG) in a deal worth a reported £47 million on Tuesday. Mbaye played 31 times in all competitions for PSG last season.

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy (semifinal), Day 4: JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
Women’s T20 Asia Cup: Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 8 p.m.
US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Thursday)

Ahead of women’s final, Strikers edge past Superstarz

DPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Before North Delhi Strikers and South Delhi Superstarz face off in the women’s final of the Delhi Premier League on Wednesday, the former derived the satisfaction of prevailing by two runs in a nail-biter at the Arun Jaitley Stadium here.

Having opted to bat on Tuesday afternoon, Strikers posted 126 for five as skipper Ayushi Soni battled her way to an unbeaten 62 off 55 balls. Samaira Raghav chipped in with a nail-biter at the Arun Jaitley Stadium here.

In reply, the Shweta Sehrawat-led side got to 124 for seven. Priya Punia was the top-scorer with a contribution of 31, but she consumed 30 deliveries in the process.

The narrow win helped Strikers finish on top of the four-team standings with 10 points. Superstarz took second spot with eight points.

Consolation win

Central Delhi Queens registered a 41-run consolation victory over East Delhi Riders in the final league match of the women’s sec-



Ayushi.

tion on Tuesday. Nidhi Mahto starred with a 53-ball 80 for Queens.

The scores: North Delhi Strikers women 126/5 in 20 overs (Ayushi Soni 62 n.o., Samaira Raghav 32, Roopali Mohan 2/23) bt South Delhi Superstarz women 124/7 in 20 overs (Priya Punia 31, Archana 2/26).

Central Delhi Queens 138/9 in 20 overs (Nidhi Mahto 80, Tamanna Singh 2/25, Bharti Rawal 3/13, Vanshika Lila 3/14) bt East Delhi Riders women 97/5 in 20 overs (Purva Siwach 30 n.o., Deeksha Sharma 3/19).

Arsenal stays flawless; Barcelona on fire

EURO LEAGUES

Agence France-Presse
BIRMINGHAM

Arsenal extended its flawless start to the Premier League season as Bukayo Saka sealed the champion’s 1-0 win against troubled Aston Villa on Monday. Saka’s second-half strike at Villa Park wrapped up Arsenal’s second successive victory.

In a statement of intent to its title rivals, Mikel Arteta’s side has taken maximum points from its opening two games without conceding a goal.

Lamine Yamal and Raphinha both struck twice as Barcelona beat Rayo Vallecano 5-2 on Monday to continue its perfect start to the LaLiga campaign.

Sergio Camello netted a brace for the visitors at Camp Nou but Hansi Flick’s Barca managed to record a third win from three matches from an entertaining battle.

The results: Premier League: Aston Villa 0 lost to Arsenal 1 (Saka 59).

LaLiga: Osasuna 1 (Budimir 45+2-pen) bt Getafe 0; Barcelona 5 (Raphinha 19, 71, Yamal 21, 90, Lejeune 51-og) bt Rayo Vallecano 2 (Camello 12, 59).

Serie A: Lecce 0 lost to Roma 4 (Malen 4, 23, Soule 25, Mora 65); Atalanta 1 (Samardzic 90+6) bt Bologna 0.

Konstas, Handscomb in Australia-A squad for tour of India

Press Trust of India
SYDNEY

Australia on Tuesday named A squads, featuring several players with senior international experience, including pacer Ben Dwarshuis, Sam Konstas and Nathan McSweeney, for the series against India-A in Puducherry later this month.

The first four-day game will begin on September 22, with the second ‘Test’ scheduled to start on September 29.

The one-dayers will be

played on October 6, 9 and 11.

Australia-A squads: Four-day matches: Brendan Doggett, Jack Edwards, Peter Handscomb, Sam Harper, Liam Hatcher, Campbell Kellaway, Sam Konstas, Nathan McSweeney, Todd Murphy, Fergus O’Neill, Josh Philippe, Jhye Richardson, Corey Rocchiccioli, Jason Sangha, Liam Scott.

One-day games: Mahli Beardman, Nikhil Chaudhary, Ben Dwarshuis, Jack Edwards, Aaron Hardie, Spencer Johnson, Sam Konstas, Nathan McSweeney, Todd Murphy, Mitch Owen, Josh Philippe, Tanveer Sangha, Liam Scott, Lachlan Shaw.

India to field four surfers at Asiad

Jayantho Sengupta
CHENNAI

India will field a four-member surfing squad at the 2026 Asian Games, ending the uncertainty over the country’s participation in the sport’s maiden appearance at the continental event.

Kishore Kumar and Sivaraj Babu will compete in the men’s shortboard event, while Kamali Moorthy and Sugar Shanthi Banarse will represent India in the women’s

competition.

The surfers were not included in an earlier list of cleared Indian participants released by the Sports Ministry, while the selection dispute involving Ramesh Budihal was before the Karnataka High Court.

Although the surfing federation had forwarded the four names in June, Budihal challenged the process through which Sivaraj was chosen as the second confirmed male athlete, with Budihal placed as the first reserve.

Dhoni fan Prithika getting ready for Asian Games debut

The youngster is sharpening her skills along with experienced teammates Jyothi and Chikitha at the Sonipat camp; she believes the Archery Premier League stint will stand her in good stead

ARCHERY

Y.B. Sarangi

A self-confessed M.S. Dhoni fan, 17-year-old compound archer Prithika Pradeep is inspired by the cricket legend’s calmness as she prepares for her Asian Games debut.

A World youth silver medallist and World Cup Stage silver medallist in 2025, Prithika made her mark by topping the Asiad selection trials and then securing individual bronze and team silver at the World Cup Stage-4 in Madrid this year.

The Nagercoil-born Prithika, who was brought up in Pune and took to archery as a hobby because she liked the name of the sport, is sharpening her skills along with experienced teammates V. Jyothi Surekha and Chikitha Taniparthi at the Sonipat camp.

“After winning the Madrid medals, I have gained in confidence. But now



Role model: Prithika says she likes the former Indian cricket team captain’s mindset, calmness and quick decision-making.

that is over. I have to focus on the Asian Games. Here, I get to learn by training

with the seniors. They share their experience. Jyothi *didi* tells me to stay

calm and give my best without taking pressure,” Prithika told *The Hindu*.

Pursuing a sport that demands composure, Prithika idolises ‘Captain Cool’ Dhoni. “My favourite is M.S. Dhoni. I admire him a lot. Novak Djokovic is also my favourite. But I like Dhoni’s mindset, calmness and quick decision-making. I read a lot of books on him.”

Prithika said last year’s inaugural Archery Premier League, where archers got 15 seconds instead of 20 to shoot an arrow, also helped her. “It gave me confidence. I enjoyed it. Exposure to foreign archers was also beneficial as they shared their experience.”

While fine-tuning her individual game, Prithika – going through the routine of meditation, warm-up, training, playing matches and gym work – is giving equal attention to teamwork. “We also train for team events – both women’s and mixed team, as we pair up with different male archers,” she said.

TN sprinters Neil and Mrithika shatter 100m records in National youth athletics

Press Trust of India
LUDHIANA

Tamil Nadu sprinters shone on the opening day of the National Youth Athletics Championships as they won the 100m gold in both the men’s and women’s sections here on Tuesday.

Promising sprinter Neil Samraj R. dominated the men’s 100m dash. His winning time of 10.46s was better than the previous youth National record of 10.63s set by Anshu Rajak in 2023 in Coimbatore.



Neil Samraj.

T. Mrithika claimed the women’s 100m gold medal, clocking 11.78s, bettering the previous meet re-



Mrithika.

cord of 11.80s set by Dutee Chand in 2012 in Bengaluru. Mrithika was the only sprinter in the final to

break the 12-second barrier.

Suchithra S. of Karnataka edged past Saawari Kulkarni (Maharashtra) to win the silver with a time of 12.03s. Saawari clocked 12.09s for the bronze.

The results: Men: 100m: 1. Neil Samraj R. (TN) 10.46s; 2. Mehebul Ahmed (WB) 10.74s; 3. Pushpendar Kumar (Del) 10.81s.

Women: 100m: 1. T. Mrithika (TN) 11.78s; 2. Suchithra S. (Kar) 12.03s, 3. Saawari Kulkarni (Mah) 12.09s. **Discus:** 1. Oshin (Har) 45.98m, 2. Dimpay Saini (UP) 43.22m, 3. Mansi Dangi (Har) 43.09m.



TVS Motor Company extends partnership with Angkor Tiger FC



Ambitious: Angkor Tiger FC finished third last year in the Cambodian Premier League. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

TVS Motor Company (TVSM), part of TVS VENU, has extended its partnership with the Cambodian Premier League team, Angkor Tiger Football Club.

The 2026-27 season partnership is the third consecutive year of continued collaboration and support from TVS Motor Company to Angkor Tiger.

The club, based in Siem Reap, is part-owned by Indian firm SkaSports and competes in the top division Cambodian Premier League. The club finished third in the Cambodia Premier League in 2025-26.

Speaking on the partnership, James Chan, senior vice-president and Head of ASEAN region at TVS Motor Company, said: “Three seasons in, our journey with Angkor Tiger FC continues to be rooted

in a shared vision of ambition and resilience for Cambodia’s youth.

“We are honoured to stand with the team and its fans once again, celebrating the power of sport to unite, inspire, and transform communities across the nation We’re delighted to continue our partnership with TVS for a third consecutive season. They believed in our vision from the very beginning, and we’re proud of how far we’ve come together. We look forward to building on that success in the season ahead,” said Rohit Ramesh, Director, SkaSports.

Akihiro Kato, Owner and Chairperson of Angkor Tiger FC added, “TVS has been more than a sponsor – they have been a trusted partner who shares our vision of building a sustainable football club that inspires the people of Cambodia.”

THE PAIR THAT DEFIED THE ODDS

Gayatri Gopichand and Treasa Jolly arrived at India’s home World Championships unseeded and short on momentum after injury. They left with bronze, emerging as one of the tournament’s most unlikely success stories and a partnership with plenty more to offer.

Pick up your copy of

SPORTSTAR

#ALLINFORSPORTS

Also inside:

India takes on the Women’s Asia Cup with a target on its back, while Mohammed Asif’s journey from pre-dawn newspaper deliveries to the national record and an Asian Games medal reveals the making of a champion.

Scan or visit [newsthehindu.com/sport](https://www.newsthehindu.com/sport) to subscribe and read the latest edition: **‘DOUBLE DELIGHT’**

Vivek Krishnan

Tributes will keep pouring in. Highlights will be replayed on loop. Memories will linger for eternity.

But the magic of watching Lionel Messi in real time in Argentina’s iconic sky blue and white stripes, spreading immeasurable joy to millions around the globe, is now a thing of the past.

The forward, all of five feet and seven inches in height but a towering figure when it came to his deeds on the football turf, has walked into the sunset after 21 years of carrying the South American nation’s expectations with grace and grandeur. Through those years, whilst playing 207 times, scoring 125 goals and winning one World Cup and two Copa America titles, the 39-year-old’s ability to illuminate a game with his stardust stayed undiluted.

A little more of Messi’s genius – be it his nimble-footed manoeuvres, magnetic control of the ball, sudden burst of speed, 360-degree vision and wide range of passing – will be glimpsed in whatever is left of his contract with Major League Soccer (MLS) club Inter Miami. But it won’t be the same as when the Argentine demigod dazzled with the ball at his feet and carved a lasting legacy at the international level, much like how Diego Maradona did for Argentina and Pele for Brazil before him.

Nothing more to give

The exit, which was announced via a long and emotional Instagram post on Monday, came as no bolt from the blue. A little more than a month after losing to Spain in the World Cup final and a few weeks after his father Jorge’s passing away, Messi had no more to give by his own admission. That was telling, for the great man, even at 39, had not shied away over the summer in North America from putting his heart and soul into trying to win a second straight World Cup for his country. He came up only narrowly short as Spain dominated with its fluid, possession-heavy style to win 1-0 in the final, a reminder that perfect farewells tend to elude even perfectionists of Messi’s ilk.

“Time is running short, chapters come to a close, and this is one that hurts me deeply. I love, have loved, and will always love being part of the national team. I’ve given everything I had; I have nothing left to give, and besides, there are some great young players coming up who deserve to be here,” Messi wrote.

As he revealed in his post, the retirement note was penned on July 21, two days after the conclusion of the World Cup. The death of his father and first coach, who had sacrificed the familiarity of life in Rosario to take his teenage son to



Messi and Argentina: A legacy that will stand the test of time

For 21 years, the left-footed forward from Rosario was *La Albiceleste*’s heartbeat, navigating his way through ups and downs with remarkable poise and inimitable brilliance. Having announced his international retirement via a post on social media on Monday, the 39-year-old brings an end to a career that entailed a record 207 appearances, 125 goals, one World Cup and two Copa America titles

GETTY IMAGES



Barcelona, on August 8 reinforced the feeling that the time was right to hang up his boots.

In a way, the fact that Messi’s time in the Argentine jersey concluded with heartbreak in the World Cup final was an apt encapsulation of his journey. The first half of his international career, which began with a sending-off on debut against Hungary in 2005, was far from a bed of roses after all. As he dribbled past defenders and netted a truckload of goals on his way to a wave of success with Barcelona at club level in the early years, a sense of alienation with fans in his homeland grew stronger. Having left for the famed surroundings of La Masia, Barcelona’s youth academy, at 13, Messi’s allegiances were routinely brought into question.

The Maradona shadow

That Messi was projected as the heir to the throne vacated by Maradona, the undisputed darling of the masses for his leading role in lifting the 1986 World Cup in Mexico, made the protege’s job all the more harder. As Argentina hurtled to an early exit in the 2010 World Cup in South Africa, incidentally under Maradona’s watch as coach, Messi, by now wearing No. 10 on his back, was the scapegoat that fans vented their ire towards.

In his propensity to produce a piece of magic out of thin air, Messi was unparalleled in the modern world. Others may go on to rack up the extraordinary numbers that he managed, but it is hard to envision anyone doing it with as much flair and elegance

The narrative received further ammunition even as Messi guided Argentina to the finals of the World Cup in 2014 and the Copa America in 2015 and 2016. The abyss was seemingly reached in the 2016 continental showpiece, when his penalty miss in the shootout of the summit clash against Chile in New Jersey condemned the proud nation to its third straight runner-up finish.

In the immediate aftermath, Messi, having grown weary of the relentless scrutiny, decided to quit altogether. “For me, the national team is over. I’ve done all I can. It hurts not to be a champion. I think this is best for everyone. First of all for me, and then for everyone else. There are many people who want that, who are not satisfied, as we are not satisfied, I suppose, with reaching the final and not winning it,” he anguished right after the Copa America final.

This was on June 26, 2016 – two days

after he had turned 29.

If he hadn’t had a change of mind soon after, how his legacy would have been construed makes for an intriguing what-if. Yes, he would have still been feted for the trophies and individual accolades accomplished with Barcelona. But would he have stood atop the pantheon of all-time greats alongside Pele and Maradona?

In hindsight, the knee-jerk exit, which was reversed three months later, ended up galvanising the country in support of Messi. His future teammates, most notably Enzo Fernandez who made a desperate plea on social media for the superstar to rethink his decision, would enter the fray with the burning desire to assist the attacker in flipping the fortunes of the national team. The fans, previously ambivalent to the skipper, also came together behind their main protagonist.

It kicked off a period of dominance of the kind that Messi & Co. had been craving. They tasted blood with victory in the Copa America in 2021, putting an end to a 28-year drought for a marquee title at the senior level.

Winning the ultimate prize

Even then, the absence of a World Cup – the holy grail of sporting events – hovered like a dark cloud over the forward going

into Qatar in 2022. Cold logic suggested that Messi, who was 35 and hadn’t succeeded in four previous attempts to hoist the ultimate prize, was well past his prime to spur Argentina to glory.

The start to the campaign was disconcertingly shaky as Argentina went down to Saudi Arabia, but then Messi, a tad slower but no less sublime and skilful, showed his wondrous capability thereafter. The slow walk across the turf became something of a signature, but if there was a sliver of space to exploit, Messi, alert as ever to the movements of his opponents, would pounce and burst forward in a flash.

He scored seven goals in West Asia, but his assists were just as eye-catching. Remember the defence-splitting pass for Nahuel Molina to score against the Netherlands, or the confluence of power and panache with which he waltzed past a significantly younger Josko Gvardiol to tee up Julian Alvarez for Argentina’s third goal against Croatia.

Cut to the just-concluded global spectacle, Messi, as if untouched by the passage of time, was remarkably wielding the same influence for the defending champion. He scored as many as eight times, taking his overall tally in the World Cup to 21 goals.

In his propensity to produce a piece of magic out of thin air, Messi was unparalleled in the modern world. Others may go on to rack up the extraordinary numbers that he managed, but it is hard to envision anyone doing it with as much flair and elegance.

In his sentimental farewell note on Monday, Messi ensured to thank all those who lent a helping hand in his fulfilling journey. It will be grossly remiss of us to not reciprocate in kind. *Gracias, Messi!*

THE GIST

If he hadn’t had a change of mind soon after, how his legacy would have been construed makes for an intriguing what-if. Yes, he would have still been feted for the trophies and individual accolades accomplished with Barcelona. But would he have stood atop the pantheon of all-time greats alongside Pele and Maradona?

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If there was a sliver of space to exploit, Messi, alert as ever to the movements of his opponents, would pounce and burst forward in a flash

In the just-concluded global spectacle, Messi, as if untouched by the passage of time, was remarkably wielding the same influence for the team



A hidden eight-note alphabet makes up every bird song in the world

The study finds that in tropical rainforests such as in Southeast Asia, birds prefer simpler songs that travel efficiently through dense vegetation, but in temperate regions such as Europe and North America birds inhabit smaller territories and have short breeding seasons, information-rich songs

Nikhil Sreekandan
BENGALURU

From the musical whistles of a red-whiskered bulbul to the mechanical whirr of a barn swallow song, there is an incredible diversity to avian music. But according to a new study by researchers from France and the U.S., this vast diversity comes from just eight building blocks.

Researchers analysed more than one lakh song recordings from more than 3,000 passerine bird species worldwide using machine learning to reveal the eight core motifs, or basic sounds.

These motifs consist of three types of trills (repetition of the same note) distinguished by their speed, three types of whistles based on their pitch modulation, and two other complex sounds.

“If you go to different countries in the world, you will hear totally different [bird] songs,” said Quentin Bacqué, one of the paper’s authors and a PhD student at the Universities of Montpellier and Saint-Étienne, France.

The central question of their study was whether it was possible to characterise the songs into broad types, Mr. Bacqué added.

The researchers also did not just deconstruct birdsong down to their sound: they also found that where birds reside influences the sounds they use.

Infinite possibilities

By sourcing data from Xeno-canto, a citizen-science repository of verified wildlife audio recordings, the researchers could analyse birdsong recordings from almost everywhere on the planet. But Mr. Bacqué said it also meant there was data disparity, with more recordings coming from Europe and the Americas than Africa.

First, the team denoised the recordings to focus on the species of interest, then converted them into high-resolution spectrograms – visual maps that show sound frequencies over time. Following this, the researchers computed a modulation power spectrum (MPS) for each song, which reduced the acoustic signals to the constituent patterns of frequency and temporal modulation.

While less precise than a spectrogram, an MPS can provide a broad perspective on timbre, pitch, tonality, and rhythm, Mr. Bacqué said.

“That’s really useful because when you have thousands of songs, you don’t want to know every detail. Instead, you want to know how similar one song is to another.”

The researchers were then able to explore the variability of these songs inside a 37-dimensional acoustic space (a 3D representation of which is available online). “It’s like all these differently shaped clouds altogether, where proximity reflects spectro-temporal similarities,” Mr. Bacqué said.

With the help of machine learning,



A red-whiskered bulbul in Satchari National Park, Bangladesh, in 2018. NAFIS AMEEN (CC BY-SA)

researchers found that all songs concentrate around eight poles in the acoustic space, each captured by a specific motif. These motifs included three types of trills – slow, fast, and ultrafast; three types of whistles – flat, slow-modulated and fast-modulated; atonal chaotic notes, which are harsh, rough sounds; and harmonic stacks, where there are several low- and high-pitched tones at once, like in the song of a crow.

The main finding is that these motifs serve as building blocks, with bird species using just one or all eight in their songs, said Pooja Choksi, co-founder and lead scientist at India Ecoacoustics Network. She was not involved in the study.

“This is a great attempt to classify and generalise across such a large group of species,” Ms. Choksi said. “At the end of the day, motifs are simply characteristics of a song, and there will probably always be a debate on how to characterise something.”

Environmental constraints

Per the study, birds, on average, use five motifs and which depends largely on their evolutionary history. “If an ancestor is using a certain motif, there is a huge chance [the current generation] is using the same motif,” Mr. Bacqué said.

Social organisation, morphology, and mating systems were the other

determining factors. Researchers found that birds communicating over long distances tend to use simple motifs like flat whistles and slow trills whereas those signalling at close range favour faster, more complex motifs.

Similarly, simpler sounds are represented better in larger birds and more challenging motifs are predominant in smaller species. Finally, their analysis revealed that groups facing intense sexual selection pressures tend to use complex motifs while species subject to weaker pressures use simpler ones.

“Song motifs are essentially a trade-off between encoding more information and transmitting it over long distances,” Mr. Bacqué said. “And what we found is this trade-off is different between temperate and tropical forests.”

Upon mapping the global geographic distribution of motifs, they found that in tropical rainforests such as in Southeast Asia, birds prefer simpler songs that travel efficiently through dense vegetation. In temperate regions such as Europe and North America, on the other hand, birds have small territories and short breeding seasons, and complex, information-rich songs.

This is the biggest finding from their research, according to Mr. Bacqué: it reveals how environmental constraints shape birdsong at a planetary scale.

“It makes logical sense that species

have adapted their songs for optimal transmission in their local environment,” Ms. Choksi said. “But it is interesting to see this pattern in such a large global analysis.” She also questioned whether the patterns would hold at much finer spatial resolutions. “The [motifs] are broad categories, and within each, there can be a lot of variation in frequency and shape,” said Elodie Briefer, an associate professor at the University of Copenhagen who was not involved with the study. So there is variation among species that share spaces, according to Ms. Briefer, whose research focuses on animal cognition and communication.

The birds themselves perceive many more nuances within these eight motifs, Ms. Briefer, who has worked closely with skylarks, added. She was, however, interested in building on this research and exploring how birds perceive these eight motifs and whether any factors influence the order in which motifs are used.

Ms. Choksi said she believes it is worth studying how habitat changes affect birdsong and mating success and reproduction. This is particularly true in India, where invasive species have proliferated and tree-planting is almost out of control, she added.

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THE GIST

- Despite the immense diversity of birdsong across different regions, the study found that these sounds can be grouped into a limited set of fundamental categories
- On average, birds use five of the eight song motifs, the study says, with the selection largely shaped by their evolutionary history
- The study’s most important finding is that environmental constraints influence birdsong patterns, shaping how birds communicate at a planetary scale

BIG SHOT



Safety suit: Penguins wear copper bodysuits designed to speed recovery after surgery for wounds often caused by entanglement in fishing nets, as the copper and zinc help prevent bacterial growth, at the Humboldt Conservation Centre, in Coquimbo, Chile, on August 27. REUTERS

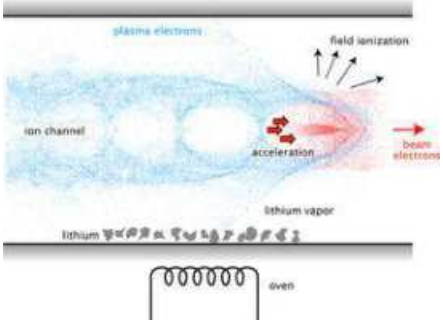
WHAT IS IT?

Wakefield accelerator

Vasudevan Mukunth

When you hear the word ‘particle accelerator’, you probably think of a giant machine with many complicated parts, and why not? Many of the world’s particle accelerators are several hundred metres long. The world’s largest science experiment is also an accelerator: the Large Hadron Collider (LHC) in Europe, which uses an assembly of powerful magnets and electric currents to push protons to nearly the speed of light through a 27-kilometre metal tube.

But not all accelerators have to be big. A technology called wakefield accelerator can fit atop a table. Such an accelerator uses a wave of plasma to push charged particles. A plasma is a gas in which some electrons have been pulled out of their atoms, creating a mix of free electrons and positively charged ions. When a laser pulse or beam of charged particles passes through the plasma, it will push the electrons aside. After the pulse or beam has departed, the ions will ‘pull’ the electrons back. But the electrons will overshoot and then oscillate back and forth, creating a travelling pattern of alternating electric fields. If you inject other electrons into this pattern, at just the right point, they



An illustration of a plasma wakefield accelerator in action. RASMUS ISCHEBECK (CC BY-SA)

can surf the moving electric fields like a surfer on a big ocean wave, drawing energy from the wave itself.

Such wakefield acceleration can produce electric fields that impart more energy to electrons across some small distance than a conventional accelerator might. However, current designs cannot accelerate electrons to more than a few tens of GeV, whereas the LHC can achieve up to three orders of magnitude more.

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